

Irish

Social

Attitudes:

2023

Topline Results from Round 11 of the European Social Survey

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## Preface

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## 0. Key points

- Trust in Others
  - gfxtgf
- Trust in Institutions
  - fgbz
- Health and Health Services
  - dzfbd.
- EU Unification and Attachment to Europe
  - dfbdf
- Life Satisfaction and Happiness
  - dfbfdz
- Economic Satisfaction and Household Income Adequacy
  - bdzbdz
- Immigration
  - Overall, attitudes towards the impact of immigration on the economy, culture, and quality of life have remained positive; however, a modest decline can be observed across all indicators in 2023. In particular, respondents are less likely to perceive immigration as making Ireland a better place to live in 2023 (mean score: 6.3) compared with the 2021/2022 ESS round (mean score: 6.9).
  - Differences in attitudes towards the impact of immigration can also be observed among respondents with different levels of educational attainment. On average, nearly 80 per cent of respondents with tertiary education in the ESS perceive immigration to have a positive impact on the economy, culture, and quality of life in Ireland. In contrast, only around 41 per cent of respondents with the lowest level of education share this view.
- Religion
  - bdzbdz
- Climate change
  - The ESS respondents in 2023 were most positive about the potential effectiveness of collective action, indicating that if large numbers of people limit their energy use, climate change could be reduced (mean score of 6.1).
  - However, respondents appear less confident that large numbers of people will actually limit their energy use (mean score 4.5) or that

governments will take sufficient action to mitigate climate change (mean score 5.0).

- Gender
  - \dfb\df

## 1. Trust

Figure 1.1: Trust in Society

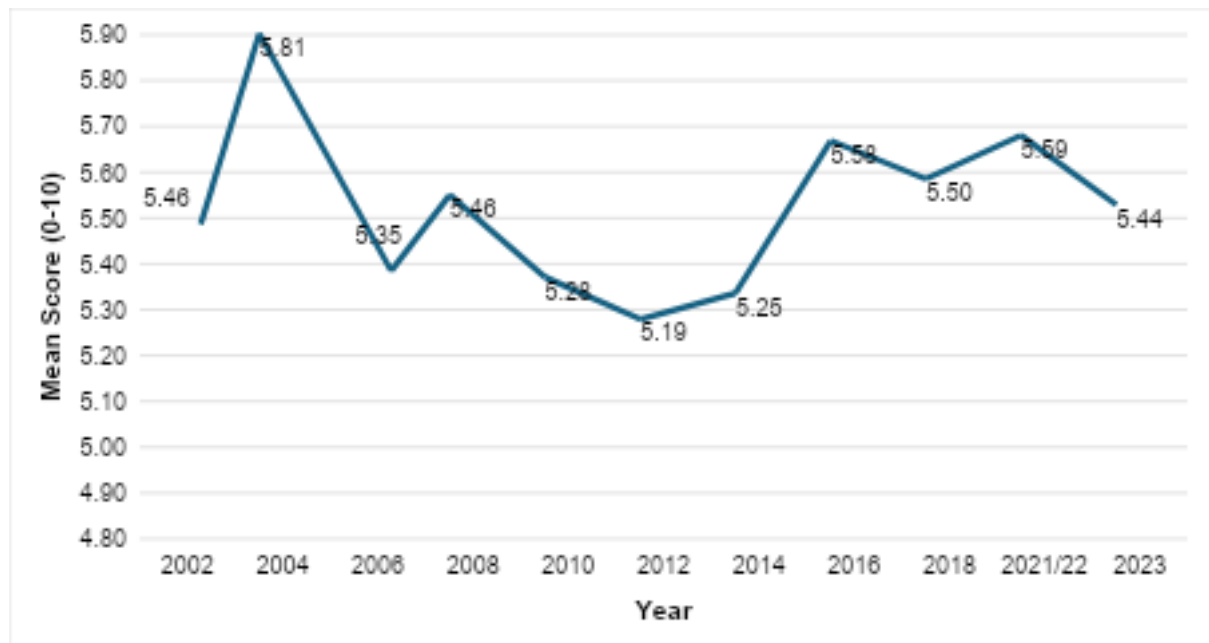
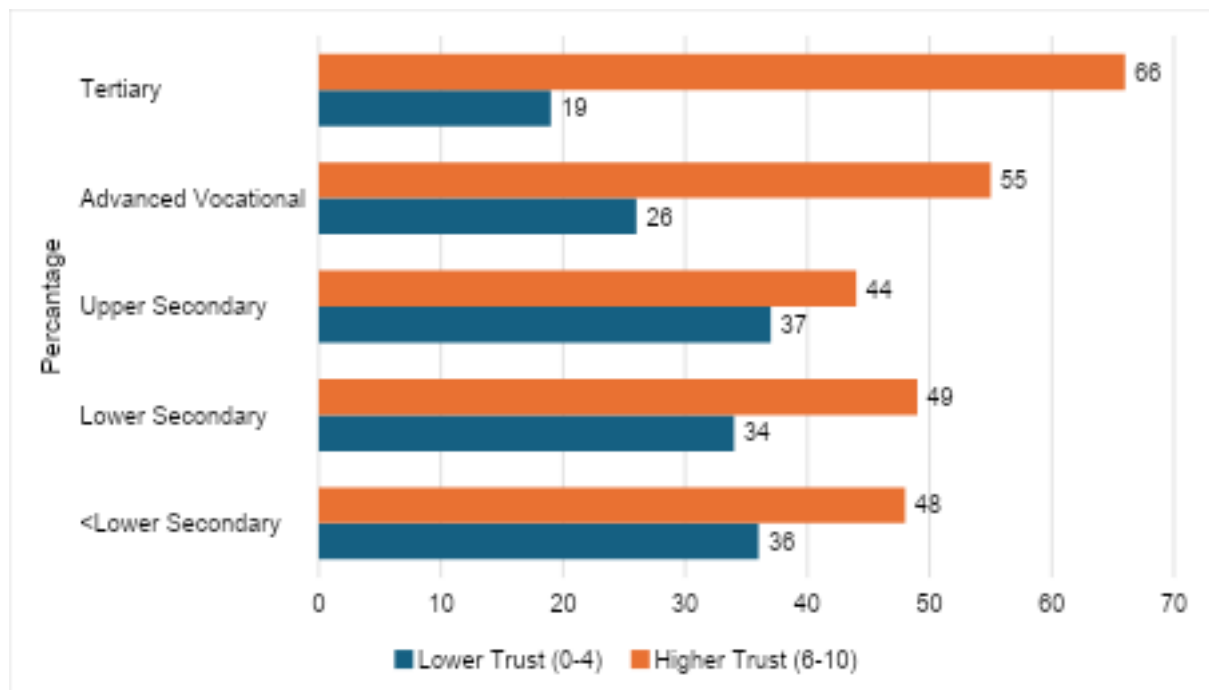


Figure 1.1 shows the trend over time in the average level of trust reported in Ireland. Trust in others was measured on a scale from “(0) you can’t be too careful” to “(10) most people can be trusted”. Between 2002 and 2021/2, the yearly averages range from 5.19 in 2012 to 5.81 when trust levels reached its peak in 2004. After this peak, we see a downwards trend until 2012; a period characterised by economic instability, crisis, austerity, and recession. The curve slowly started to climb again after this period and stabilised around 5.5. Between 2016 and 2021/2, the average level of trust hovered around 5.5 with a small drop in 2023. See Question 1 (A4 in ESS10) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 1.1.

Figure 1.2: Trust in society by Education



The level of trust varies by completed level of education, which is shown by the proportions in Figure 1.2, which are derived from the same question as the averages reported in Figure 1.1. Respondents with tertiary education exhibit higher levels of trust with 66% indicating their trust to lie between 6 and 10 on the question's original 11-point scale. The level of trust of individuals with advanced vocational degrees lies in between those with a secondary and tertiary degree. Specifically, there is limited variation between the various secondary school degrees. See Question 1 (A4 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 1.2.

## 2. Trust in Institutions



Figure 2.1: Low and High Trust in Political Actors and Institutions

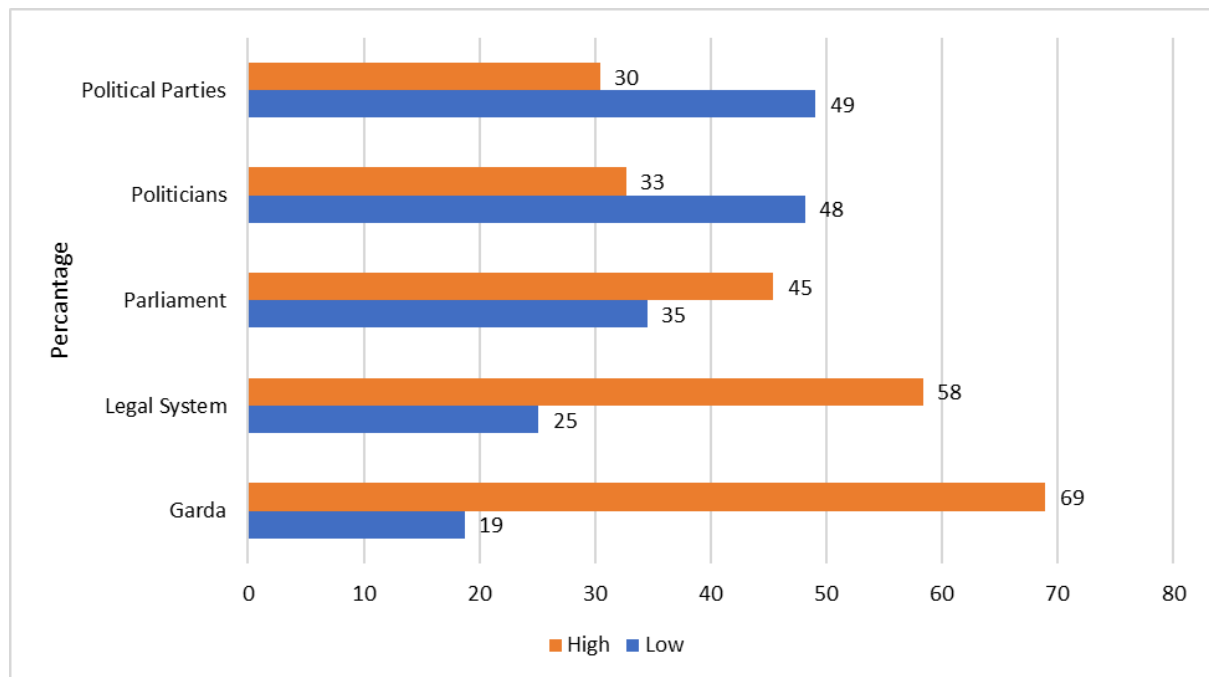


Figure 2.1 reports the percentage indicating lower and higher levels of trust in Irish institutions. We see the highest level of trust in An Garda Síochána (i.e., police). 69% of the respondents answered between 6-10 (higher levels of trust) on a scale where 0 indicates 'No trust at all' and 10 signals 'Complete trust'. After An Garda Síochána, the legal system is the next most trusted institution with 58% of the respondents indicating high trust (i.e., a response of between 6 and 10, inclusive). Notably, politicians and political parties are trusted comparatively less with nearly half of the respondents indicating a lower level of (i.e., a response of between 0 and 4, inclusive). See Question 2 (B7-B10 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 2.1

Figure 2.2: Trust in Political Actors and Institutions

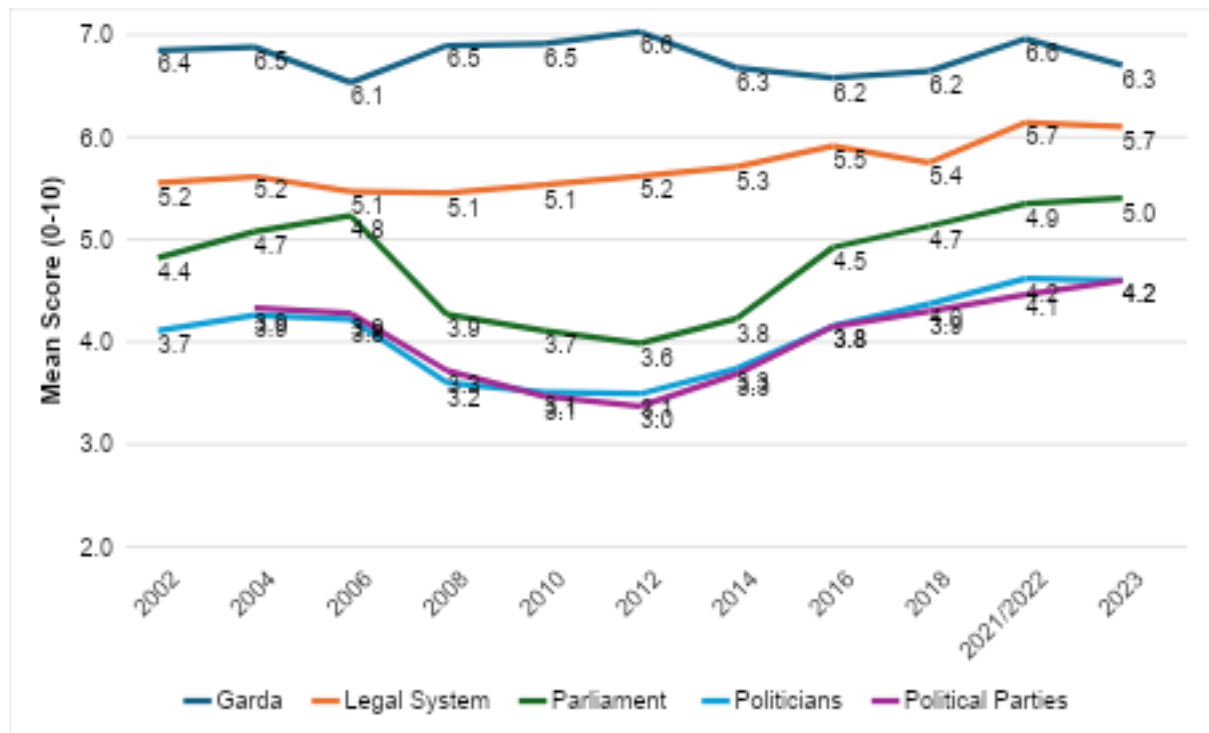


Figure 2.2 reports the average level of trust in political actors and institutions on an 11-point scale, where 0 indicates no trust and 10 indicates complete trust, over the period 2002–2023. Trust in An Garda Síochána (the police) remains consistently higher than for other actors and institutions and relatively stable overall, with minor declines around 2006 and after 2012. Following a recovery by 2021/22, there is a small decline in 2023, though trust levels remain high compared to other institutions. Trust in the legal system shows a similarly stable pattern with modest fluctuations, reaching slightly higher levels by 2023. In contrast, trust in the parliament, politicians, and political parties are lower on average. For these actors, trust declines sharply during the economic crisis period (approximately 2008–2012), reaching a low point around 2012, before gradually recovering. By 2023, trust appears to have returned to, or slightly exceeded, pre-crisis levels. Question 2 (B6-B10 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 2.2.

Figure 2.3: Higher Levels of Trust in Politics and Institutions

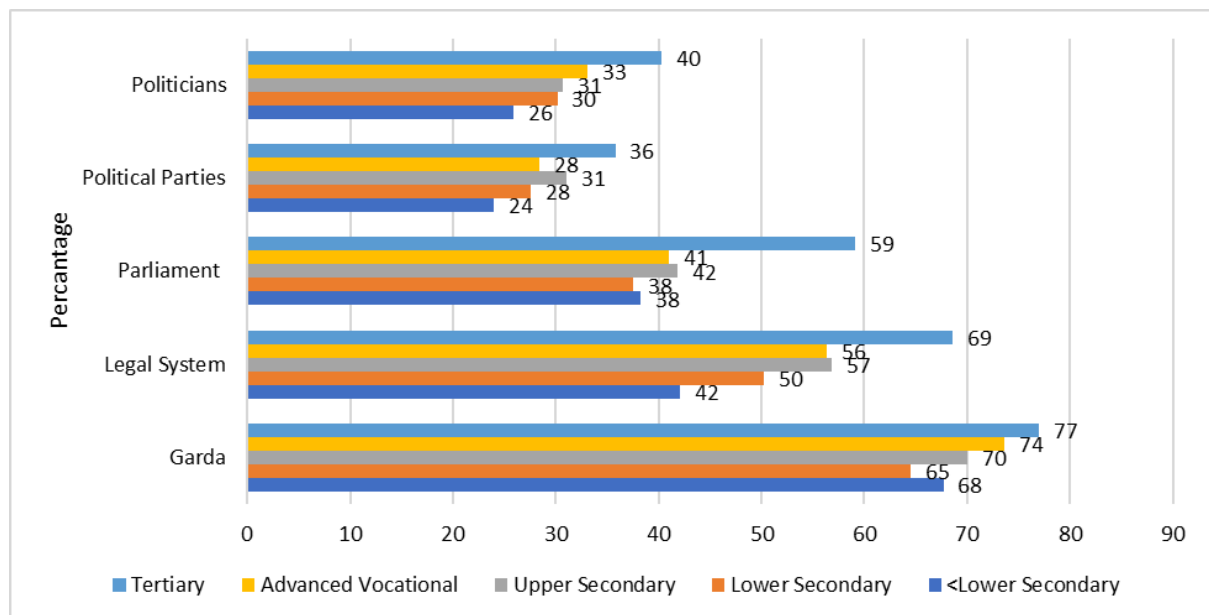


Figure 2.3 shows the percentage of respondents reporting higher levels of trust in political actors and institutions, measured by responses of 6 through 10 on a scale where 10 indicates complete trust. A clear pattern emerges: levels of trust increase with higher educational attainment. Respondents with tertiary education report higher levels of trust across all categories. The largest gaps between those with tertiary education and other educational groups appear in trust in parliament (59%) and the legal system (69%). Highly educated respondents (i.e., those with a tertiary degree) report the greatest trust in the police, followed by the legal system and parliament. See Question 2 (B6-B10 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 2.3.

### 3. Health and Health Services

Figure 3.1: Reported Health Conditions

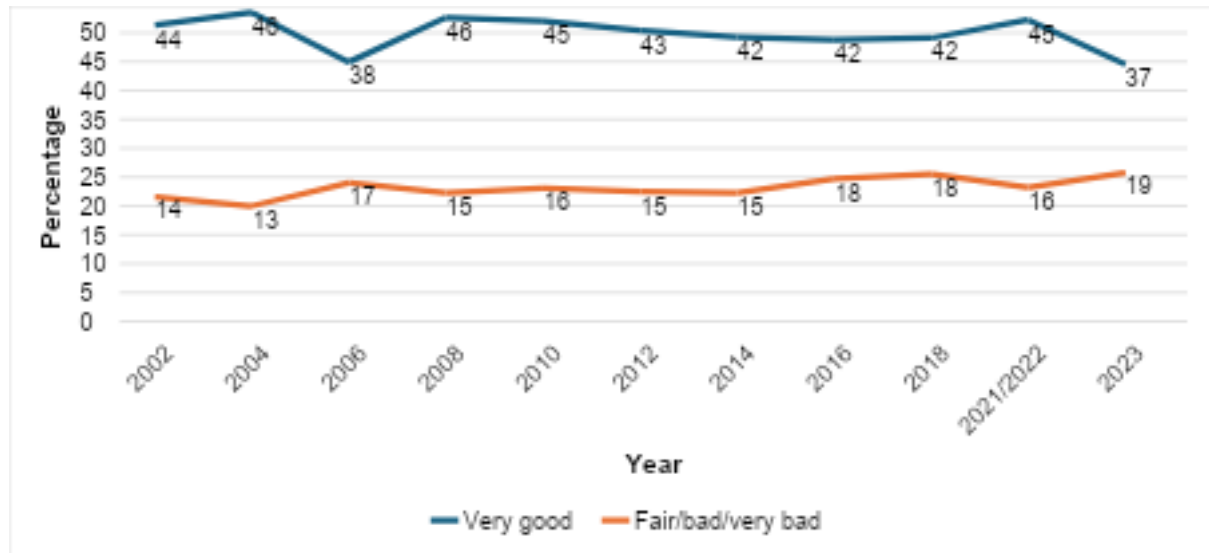


Figure 3.1 compares the percentage that report poorer health, defined by self-reported health of fair/bad/ very bad, to those who consider their health to be very good.....

See Question 3 (C7 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.1.

Figure 3.2: Reported Health Conditions by Employment Status and Education

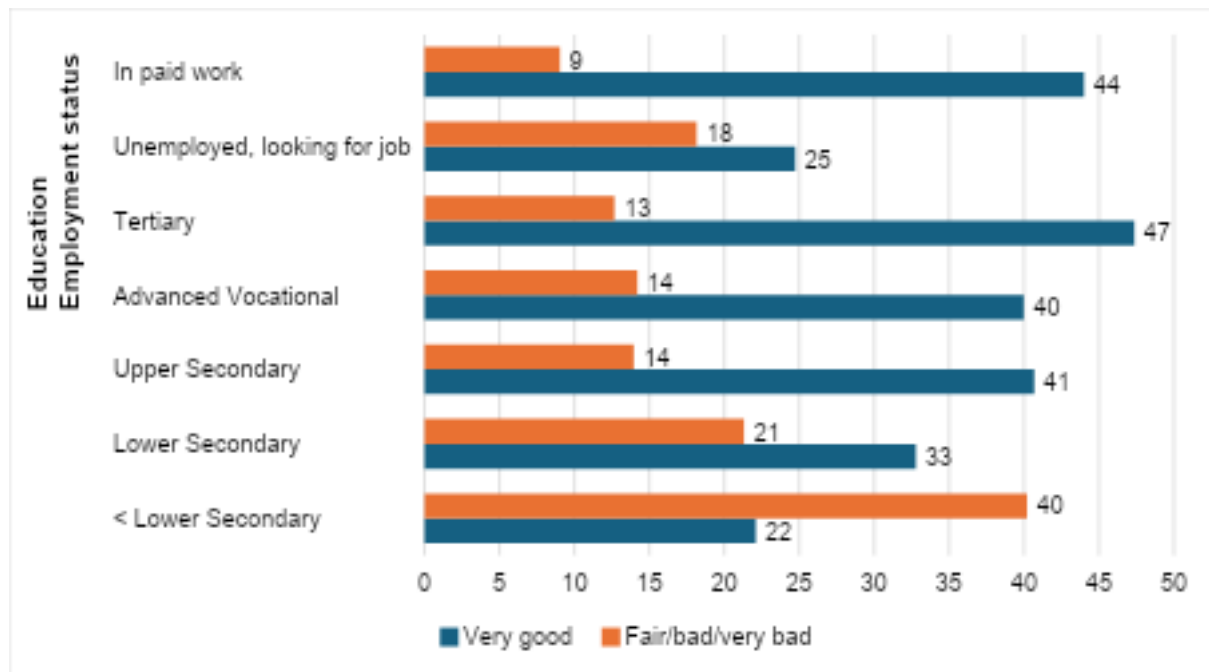


Figure 3.2 reports the distribution of self-reported health by employment status and level of completed education.....

See Question 3 (C7 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.2.

Figure 3.3: Good Health and the Income Distribution

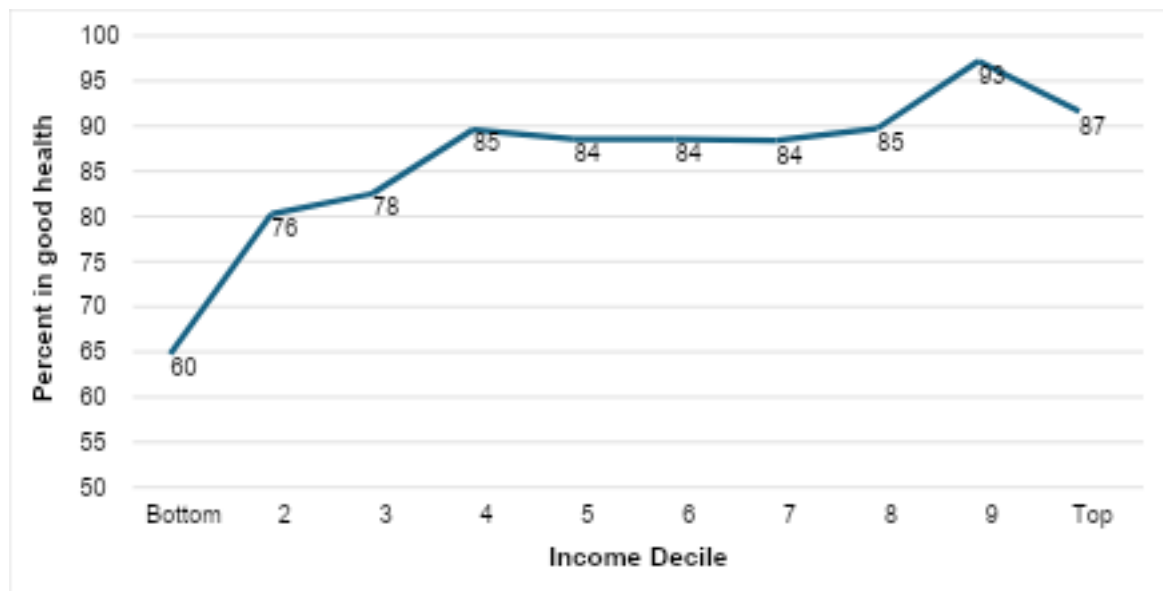


Figure 3.3 reports the pattern of self-reported good health by income decile.

.....

See Question 3 (C7 in ESS11) and Q4 (F41 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.3.

Figure 3.4: Higher Satisfaction with the Health Care System and “very good” Health, by Age

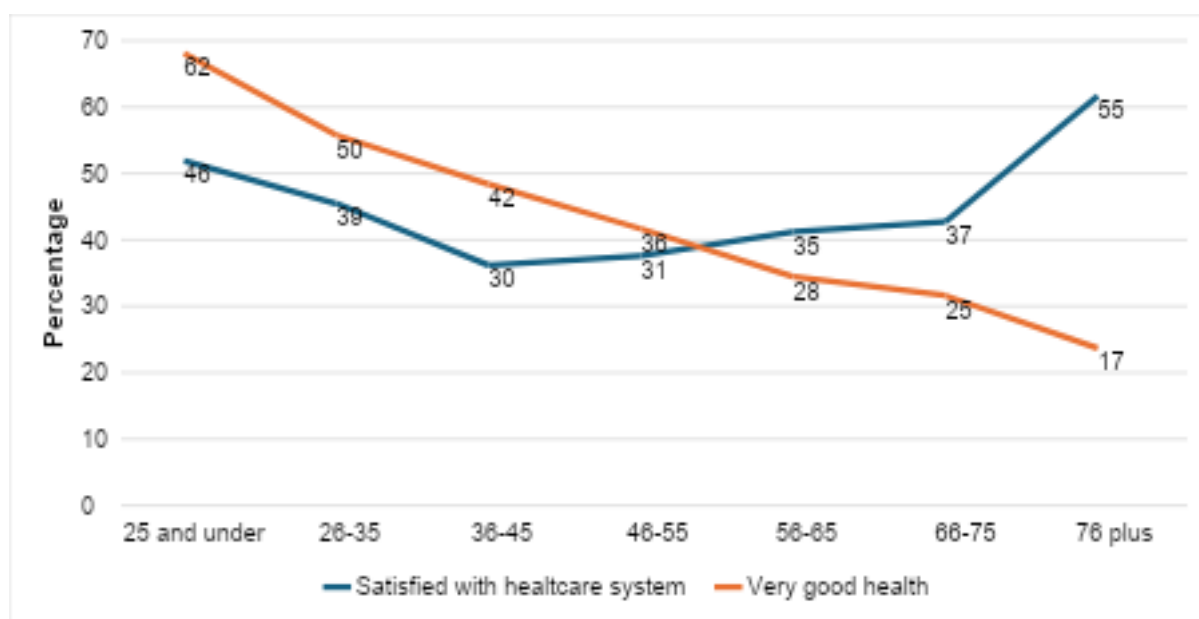


Figure 3.4 shows the trend in self-reported very good health and satisfaction with the healthcare system in Ireland by age categories.....

See Question 3 (C7 in ESS11) and Question 5 (B32 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.4.

Figure 3.5: Happiness, General Health and the Income Distribution

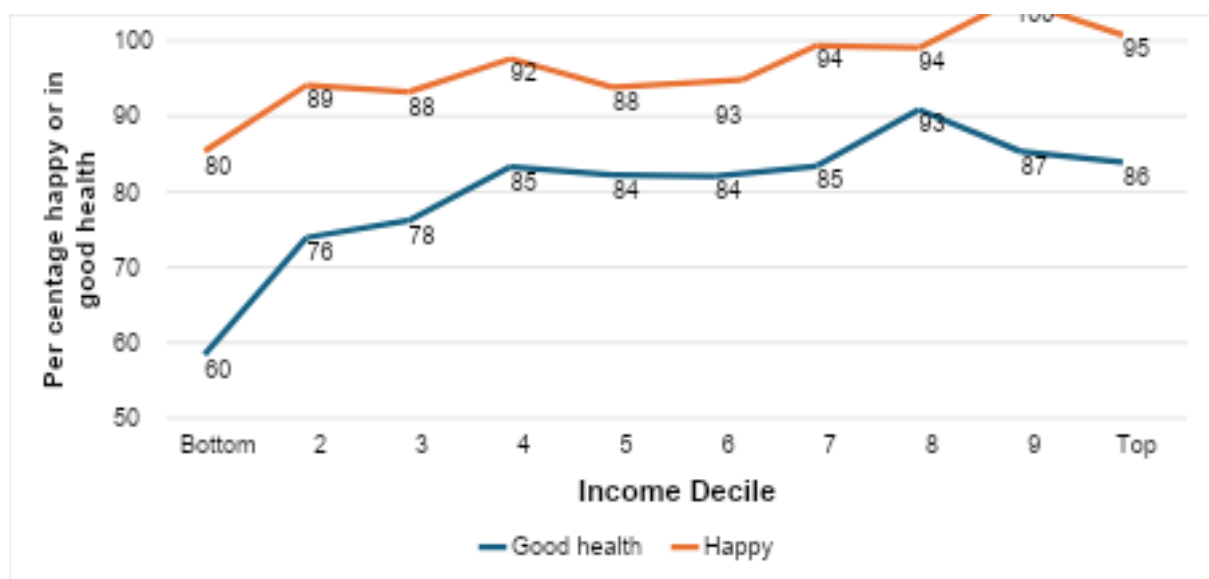


Figure 3.4 shows the trend in self-reported very good health and happiness in Ireland by income categories.....

See Question 6 (C1 in ESS11) and Q4 (F41 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.4.



Figure 3.5: Reported Health Problems in The Last 12 Months



This question and the following ones were specific to the rotating module on Inequalities in Health for round 10. ....

See Question 7 (D28 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.5.

Figure 3.6: Unable to Get Medical Consultation or Treatment in the last 12 months

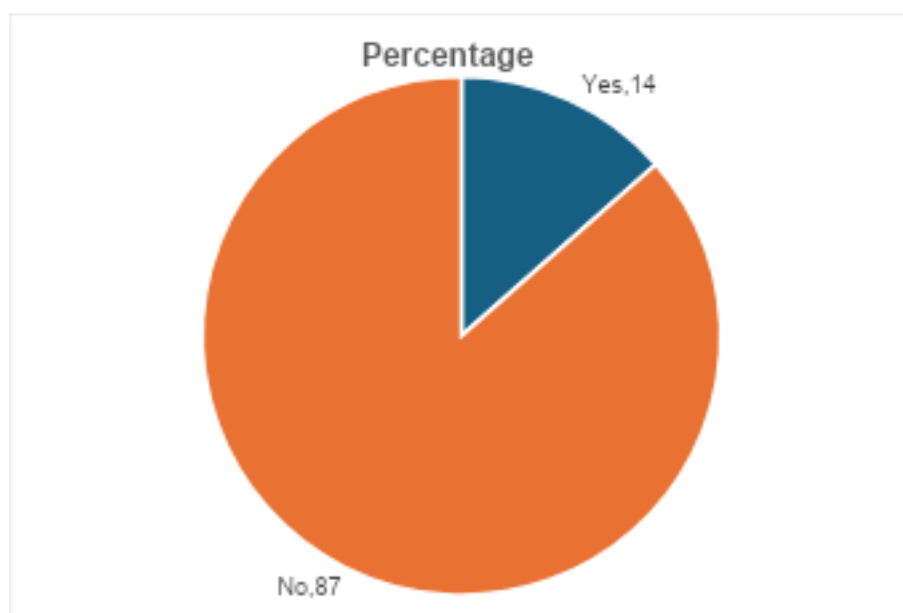


Figure 3.6 shows.....

See Question 7 (D28 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.6.

Figure 3.7: Feelings in the past week

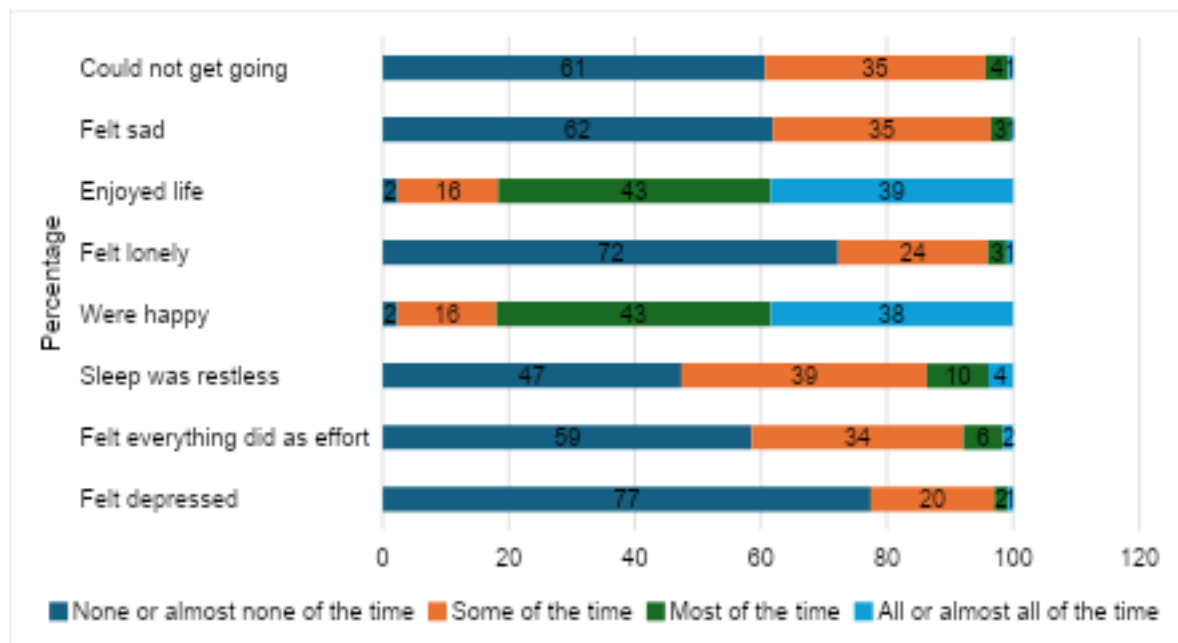


Figure 3.7 shows.....

See Question 8 (D21-27 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.7.

Figure 3.8: Problems with accommodation

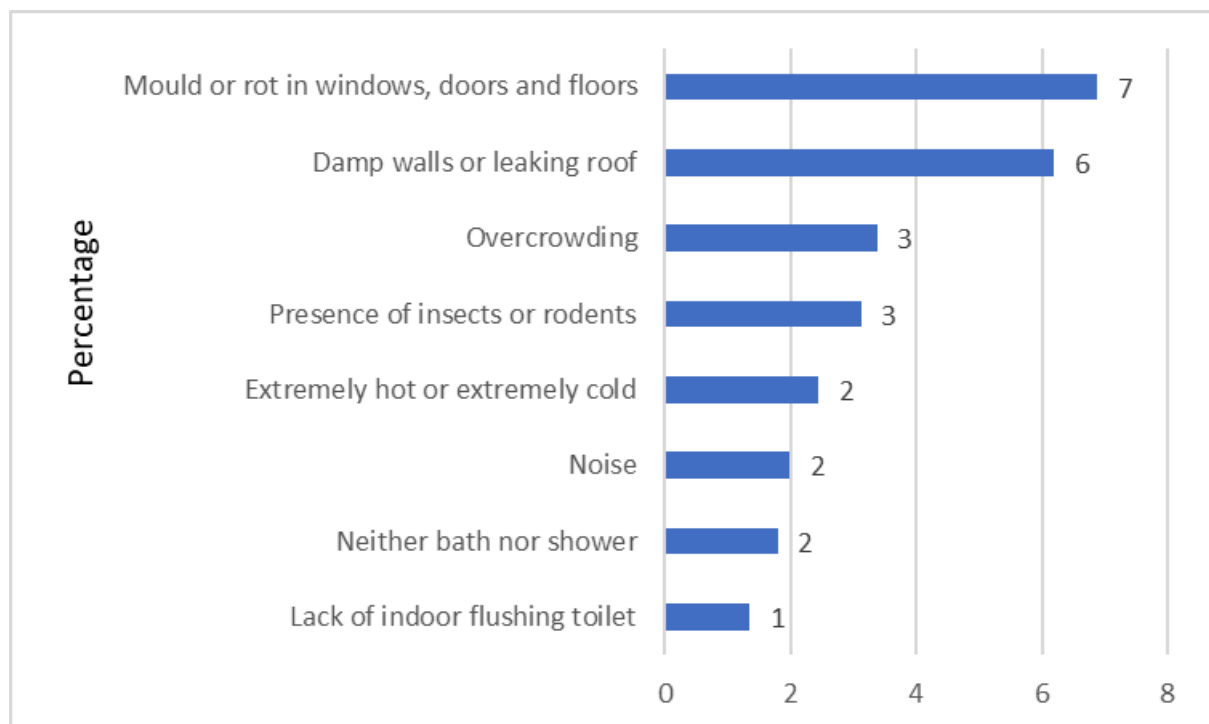


Figure 3.8 shows.....

See Question 9 (F14a in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 3.8.

#### 4. European Unification and Attachment to Europe

Figure 4.1: Trust in EU Parliament, Acceptance of further EU Unification, and Emotional Attachment to Europe

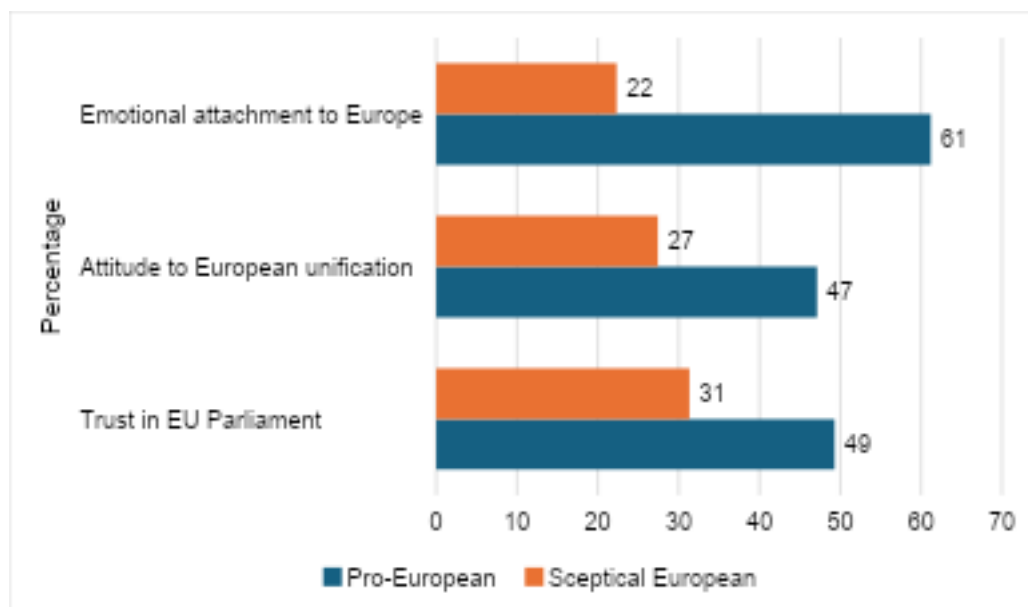


Figure 4.1 considers attitudes toward the European Union using three related questions. The questions about trust in the EU Parliament ranges from ‘no trust at all’ (0) to ‘complete trust’ (10). Attitudes toward EU unification range from ‘Has already gone too far’ (0) to ‘Should go further’ (10). Emotional attachment to Europe ranges from ‘Not at all emotionally attached’ (0) to ‘Very emotionally attached’ (10).....

See Question 10 (C9 in ESS11) Question 11 (B37 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 4.1.

Figure 4.2: Trust in the EU Parliament and Attitudes to EU Unification in Ireland

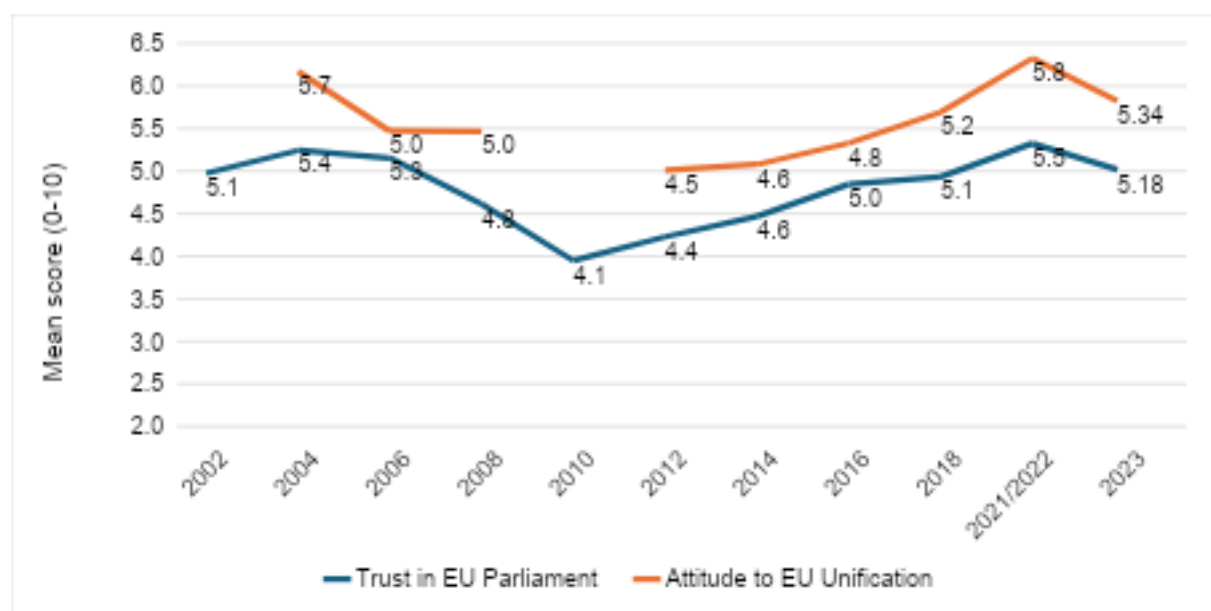


Figure 4.2 reports that average response to the 11-point question on trust in the EU Parliament and perception EU unification, which was used to estimate the percentages reported in Figure 5.1. The general perception of Europe declined during the economic crisis (2008-2012), reaching a new low around the time that Ireland was drawn into the EC-ECB-IMF Economic Adjustment Programme in 2010. While trust in the EU parliament increased in subsequent years.....

See Question 11 (B37 in ESS11) and Q12 (B11 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 4.2.

Figure 4.3: Trust in EU Parliament, Support for EU Unification and Attachment to Europe by Educational Attainment

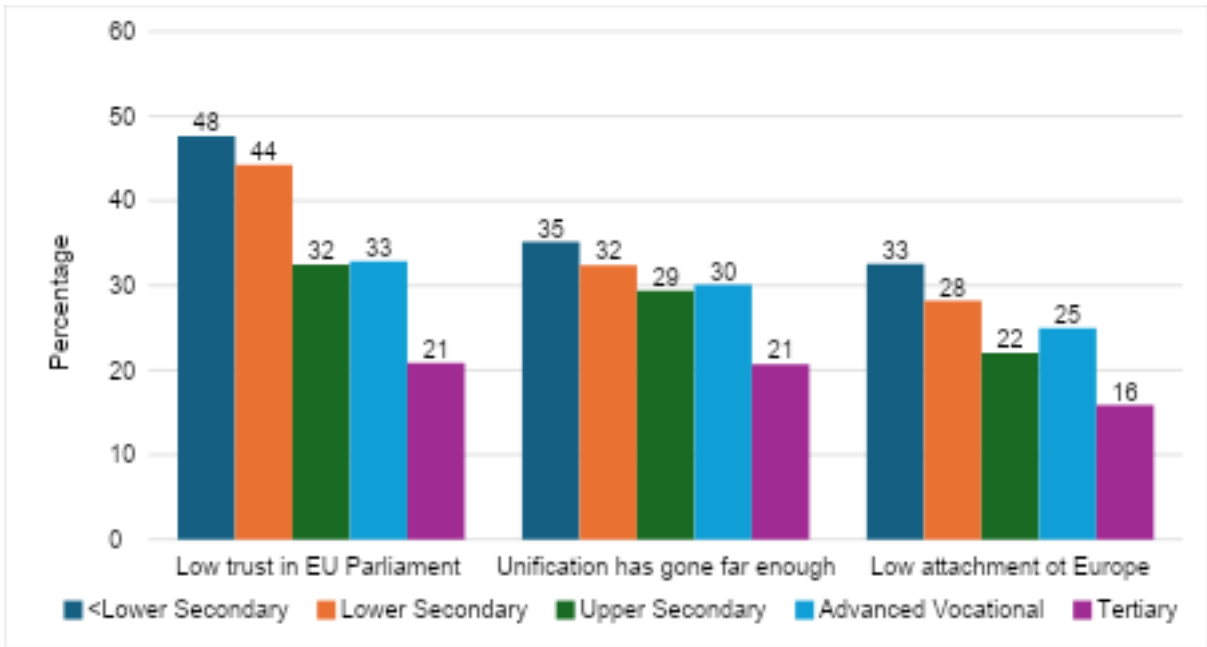
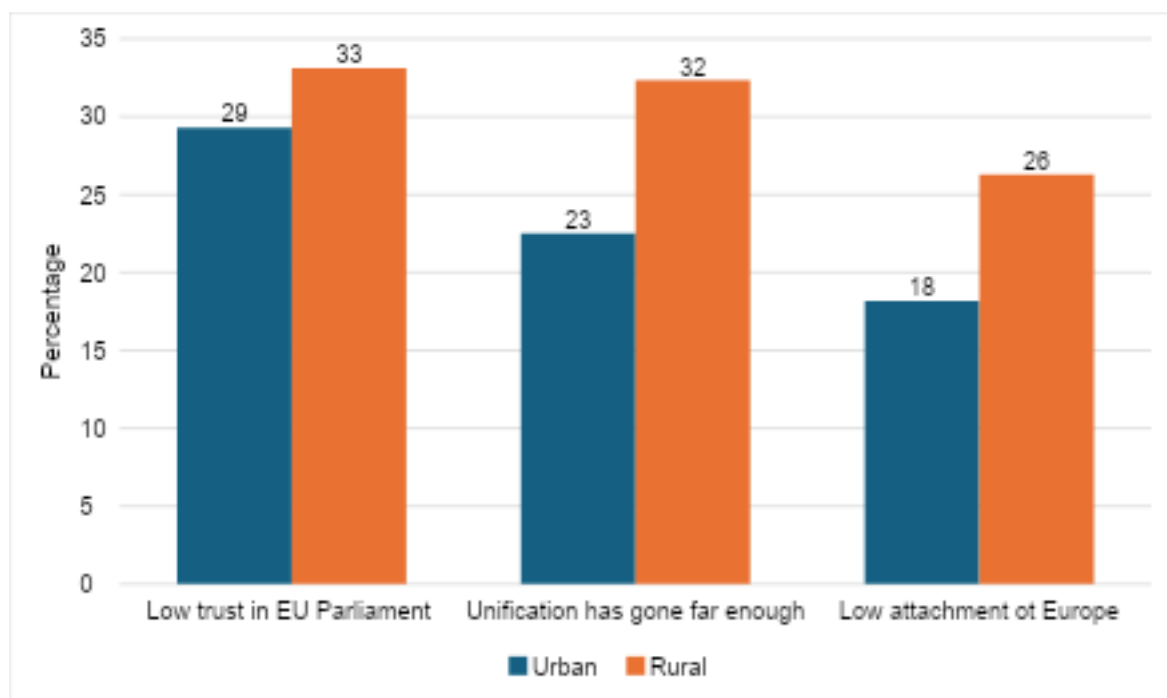


Figure 4.3 reports the distribution of Eurosceptic respondents for three questions about perception of Europe in Ireland (see description of Figure 5.1 for details about the questions and definition of Euroscepticism).....

See Question 10 (C9 in ESS11), Question 11 (B37 in ESS11), Q12 (B11 in ESS11) and Question 13 (F15 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 4.3.

Figure 4.4: Relatively Low levels of Trust in EU Parliament, Support for EU Unification and Attachment to Europe by Urban and Rural Residence



This is reflected in the greater percentage Eurosceptic among rural respondents in each of the questions reported in Figure 4.4.....



See Question 10 (C9 in ESS11), Question 11 (B37 in ESS11) and Q12 (B11 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 4.4.

## 5. Life Satisfaction and Happiness

Figure 5.1 Life Satisfaction and Happiness



Figure 5.1 indicates a limited change in people's level of life satisfaction when compared to 2016 and 2018. When asked to rate "how satisfied are you with your life as a whole nowadays?" on a scale from 0 (extremely dissatisfied) to 10 (extremely satisfied), the average response in 2023 was 7.4 with no change to the previous wave 2021/2. In general, people's life satisfaction has remained high for the period reported in Figure 5.1. That said, it dipped to its lowest level (6.6) in 2010 coinciding with the Great Recession and the severe socio-economic context in Ireland from about 2008 to 2012. People's level of happiness, measured on a scale from 0 (extremely unhappy) to 10 (extremely happy), follows a similar pattern. In addition, the average happiness level is back to 7.7 as before the pandemic (2018); the COVID-19 seems to have had surprisingly little impact.

See Question 13 (B27 in ESS11) and See Question 6 (C1 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 5.1.

Table 5.1. Life Satisfaction and Employment Status

|                                  | Percent Satisfied | Percent Dissatisfied |
|----------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------|
| In paid work                     | 86,2              | 13,8                 |
| Unemployed, looking for job      | 70,8              | 29,2                 |
| Inactive (not looking for a job) | 85,0              | 15,0                 |
| Refusal/Don't know               | 16,5              | 83,5                 |
| <b>Total Population</b>          | 85,1              | 15,0                 |

Note: Scale ranges from 0 (extremely dissatisfied) to 10 (extremely satisfied). Satisfied includes those scoring in the range 6-10, dissatisfied includes those scoring in the range 0-4. Table 5.1 highlights one further decomposition of the 2021/2 life satisfaction variable, delineating the percentage satisfied and dissatisfied by employment status. It outlines the proportion of individuals who are satisfied or dissatisfied by employment status. Overall, a greater proportion of those in paid work report being satisfied. That said, those who are inactive and not looking for a job seem almost equally satisfied while those looking for a job are the most dissatisfied.

See Question 13 (B27 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 5.1.

## 6. Economic Satisfaction and Household Income Adequacy

Figure 6.1: Satisfied with the Present State of the Economy

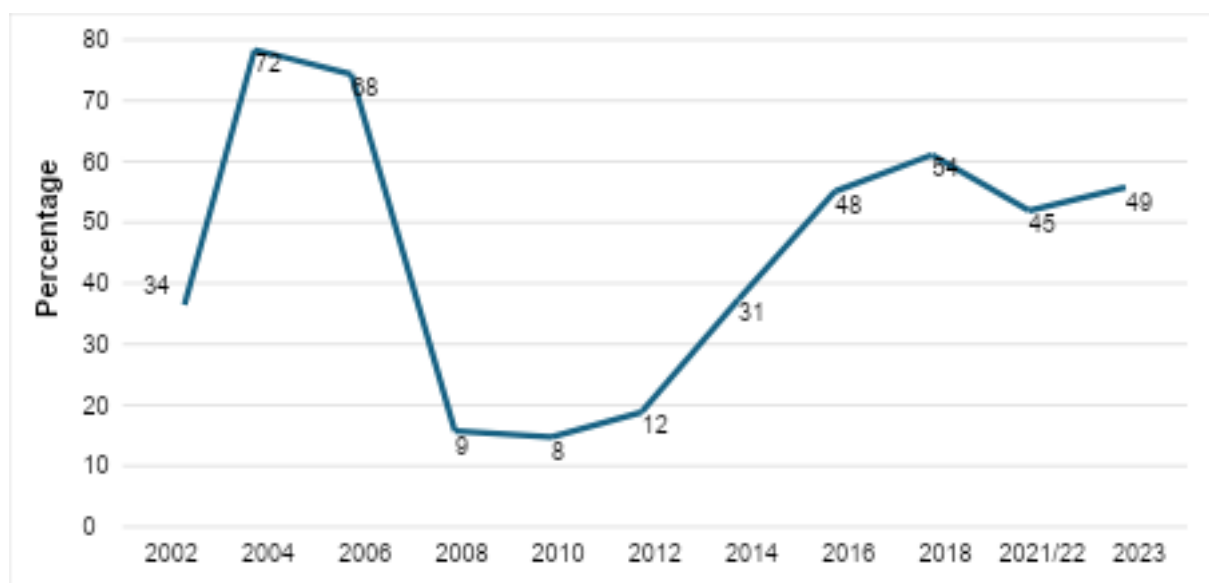


Figure 6.1 indicates that the Irish population's satisfaction with the present state of the economy .....Scale ranges from 0 (extremely dissatisfied) to 10 (extremely satisfied). Satisfied includes those scoring in the range 6-10.....

See Question 14 (B28 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 6.1.

Figure 6.2: Satisfaction with the Present State of the Economy by Age Groups

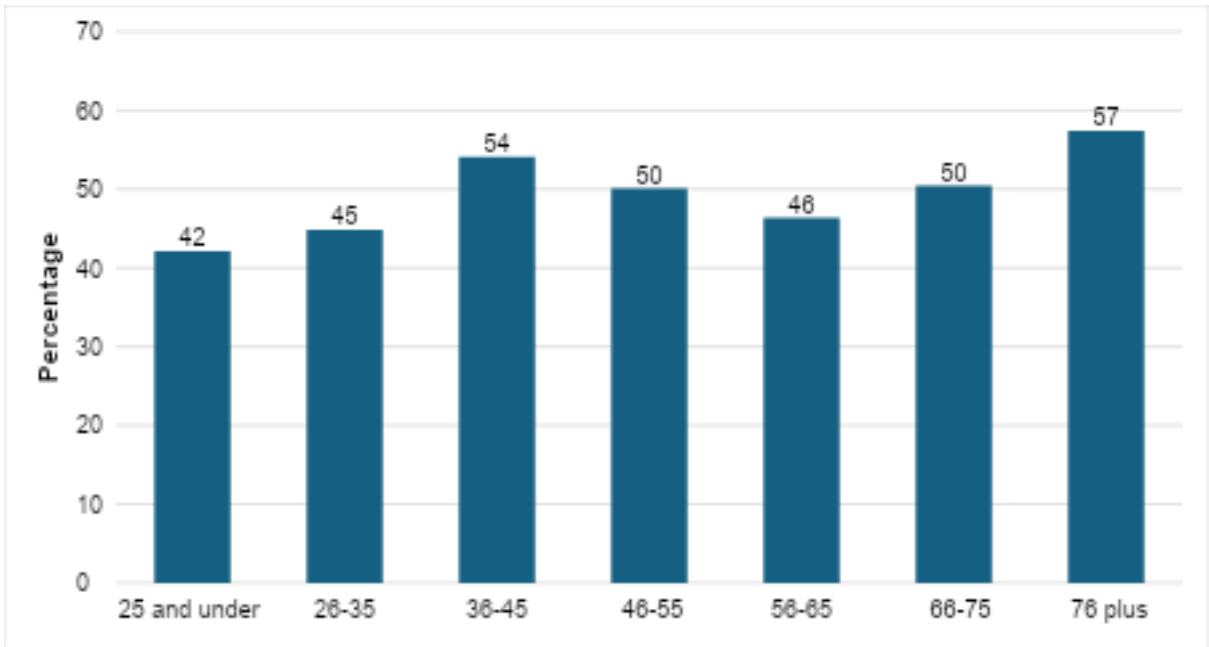


Figure 6.2 reveals notable differences in the perception of the current state of the economy in Ireland by age-group.....

See Question 14 (B28 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 6.2.

Figure 6.3: Perception of Household Income by Income Quintile

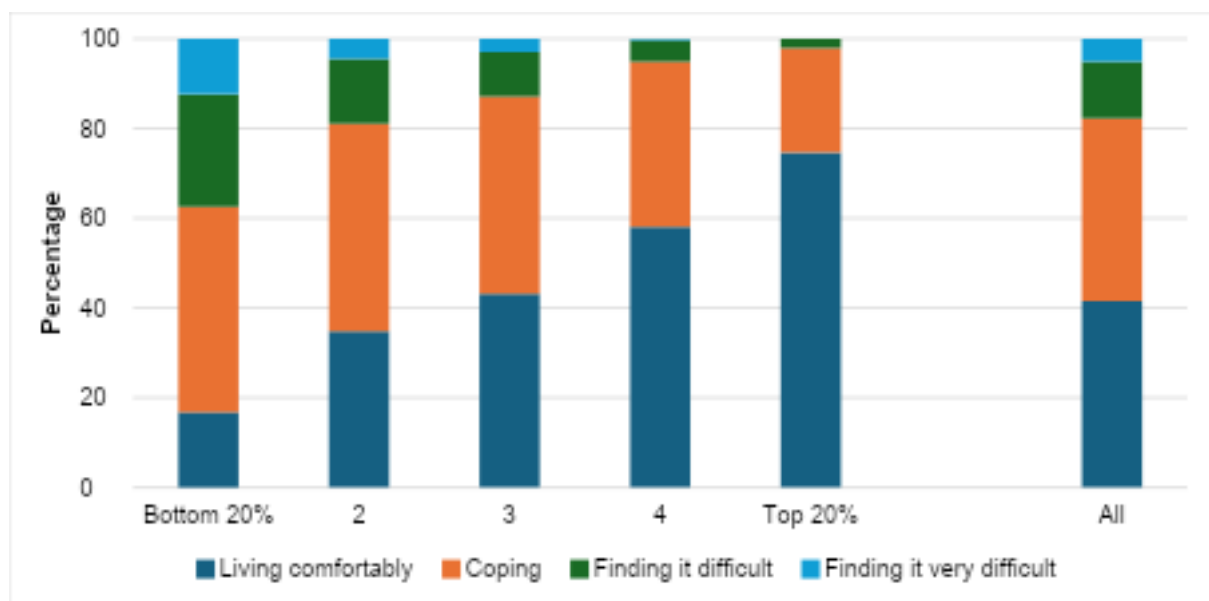


Figure 6.3 provides further insight into attitudes toward the macroeconomic context in Ireland, measuring respondents' perception of their household's current income.....

See Question 15 (F42 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 6.3.

## 7. Immigration

Figure 7.1: Perception of the Impact of Immigration on the Economy, Culture, and Life

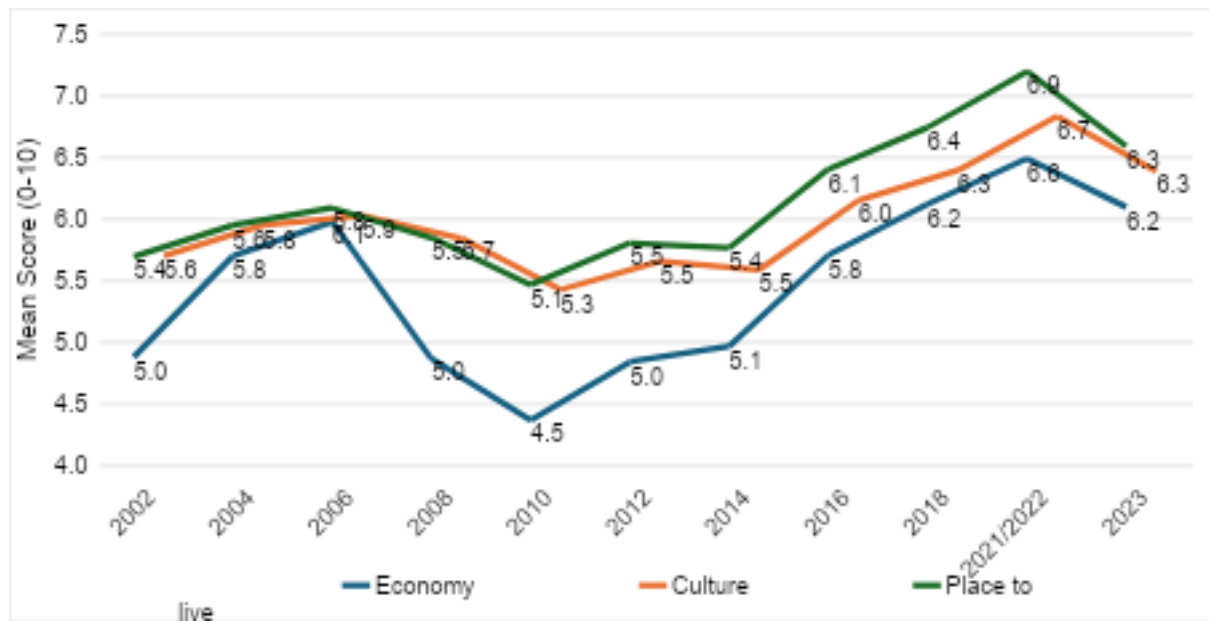


Figure 7.1 reports the average response to three related questions on the perceived impact of immigration to Ireland. Specifically, respondents report how they see immigrants' economic role [(0) Bad... (10) Good], cultural influence [(0) Undermine... (10) Enrich] and impact on life [(0) Worse... (10) Better] in Ireland. Higher averages indicate a relatively more positive perception of the role of immigration. Ireland, traditionally considered a country of emigration, has experienced significant inward migration since the mid-1990s. Data from the European Social Survey since 2002 indicates that overall public attitudes toward immigration have remained generally positive, a pattern reflected in Figure 7.1. Attitudes towards the impact of immigration on the economy, culture, and quality of life were least positive in 2010, in the period following the 2008 financial crisis. Perceptions of immigration's impact on the economy were consistently lower than those relating to culture and overall quality of life, declining sharply between 2008 and 2010 to an average score of 4.5. However, these perceptions gradually improved in subsequent years, reaching 6.6 in 2021–2022. The economic impact of immigration appears to be closely linked to the overall economic context. In contrast, views on the cultural influence of immigration and its effect on life in Ireland remained consistently more positive. Perceptions of cultural impact increased from 5.6 in 2002 to 6.7 in 2021–2022, while views on whether immigration makes Ireland a better place to live rose from 5.4 in 2002 to 6.9 in 2021–2022. The most recent data indicate a slight decrease across all three indicators, particularly regarding whether immigration makes Ireland a better place to live, which declined to 6.3. This may reflect a recent shift towards more restrictive or negative public perceptions of immigration in Ireland. Nevertheless, despite this modest decline in 2023, the overall trend suggests that ESS participants in Ireland increasingly perceive immigration as having a positive impact on the country's economy, culture, and quality of life. Continued monitoring of these attitudes remains important. See Question 16-17-18

(B43-44-45 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 7.1

Figure 7.2: Percentage Who Positively view the Impact of Immigration on the Economy, Culture and as a Place to Live by Education

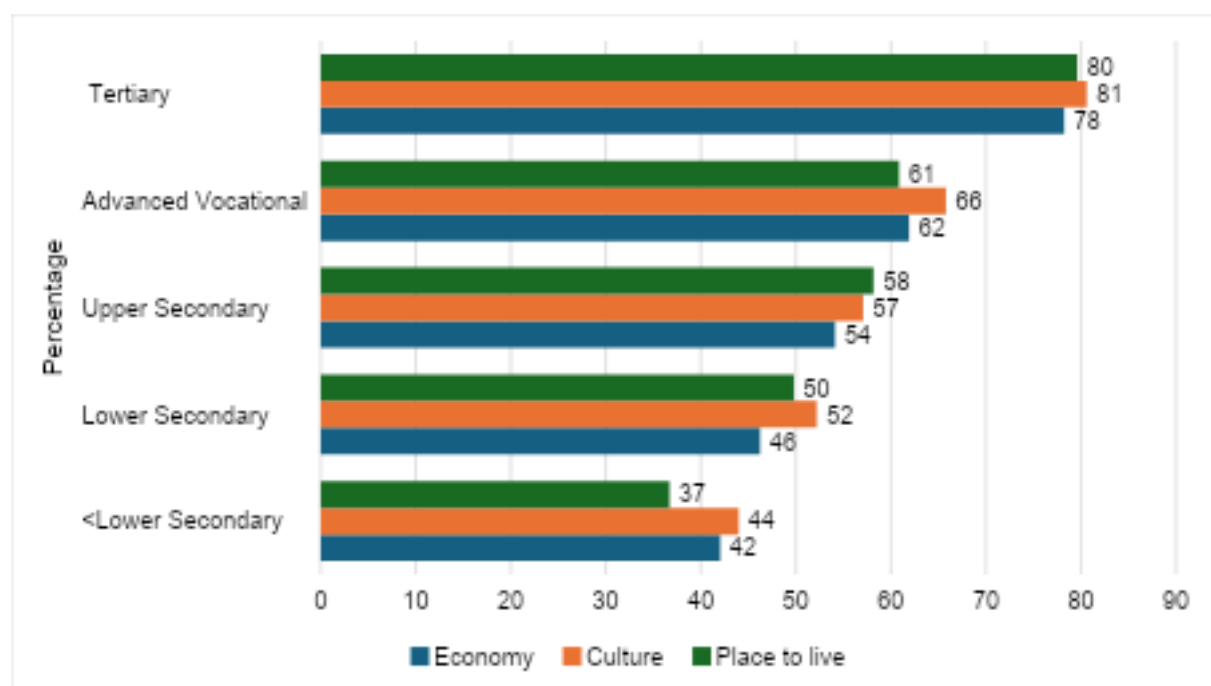


Figure 7.2 reports the percentage of the population that reports a value of 6 or more on the 11-point scale used to measure attitudes toward the impact of immigration on the economy, culture, and life in Ireland. The bars in the figure are interpretable as the percentage of Irish society that sees immigration as economically beneficial, culturally enriching and an improvement in life in Ireland. Overall, relatively little variation can be observed within each education group regarding attitudes towards the economic, cultural, and overall life impacts of immigration. Across most education levels, the perceived cultural impact of immigration is the most positive. However, when comparing different levels of educational attainment, significant



differences emerge. Respondents with tertiary education display significantly more positive attitudes across all three indicators compared with those at lower levels of education. The most notable difference exists between respondents with the highest level of education (tertiary) and those with the lowest level (less than lower secondary). On average, nearly 80 per cent of respondents with tertiary education in the ESS perceive immigration to have a positive impact on the economy, culture, and quality of life in Ireland. In contrast, only around 41 per cent of respondents with the lowest level of education share this view. This disparity is particularly evident in perceptions of whether immigration makes Ireland a better place to live. While 80 per cent of respondents with tertiary education view immigration positively in this regard, only 37 per cent of respondents with the lowest level of education do so, resulting in a substantial 43 percentage point gap between the two groups. See Question 16-17-18 (B43-44-45 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 7.2.

Figure 7.3: Percentage who Positively View the Impact of Immigration on the Economy, Culture and as a Place to Live by Employment Status

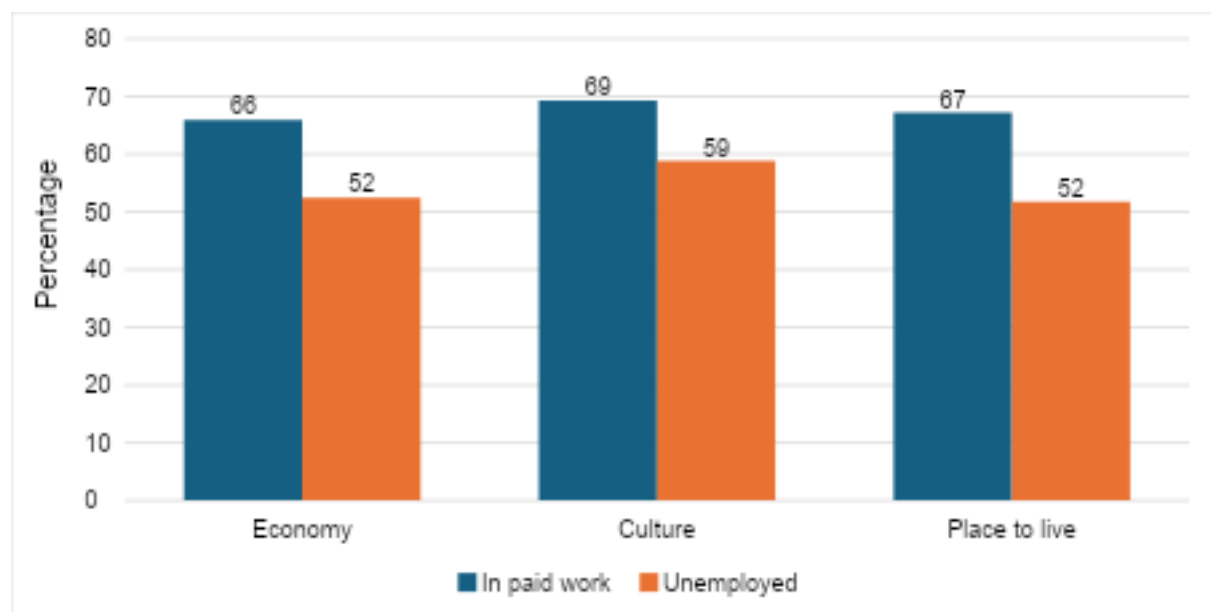
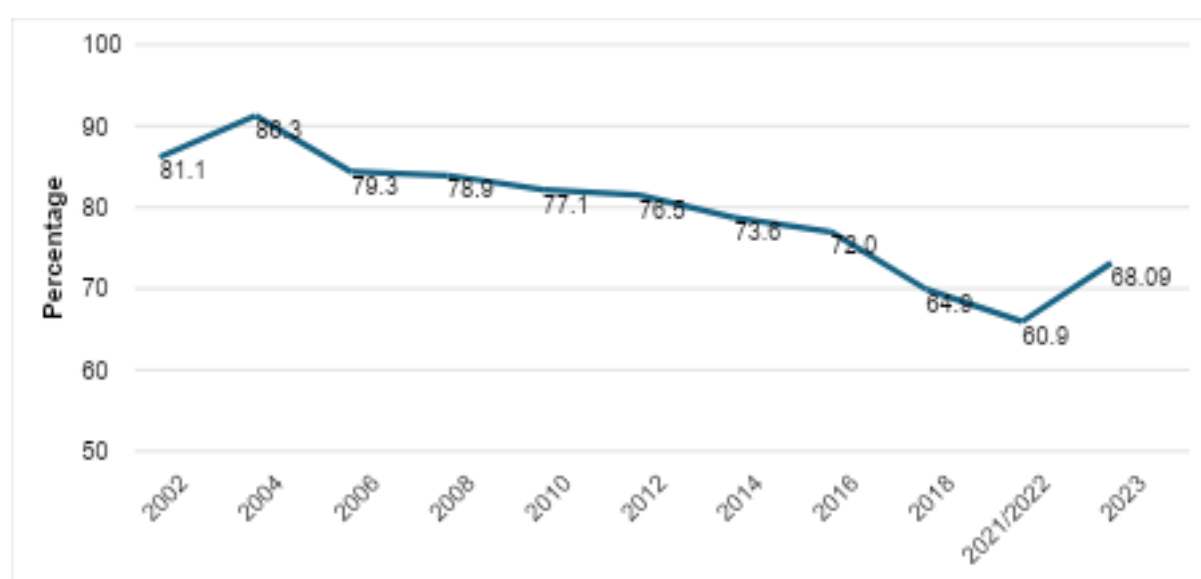


Figure 7.3 compares those employed to those unemployed but seeking employment. As with Figure 7.2, the percentage captures the percentage of the population that reports a value of 6 or more on the 11-point scale and is interpretable as the part of Irish society that sees immigration as economically beneficial, culturally enriching and an improvement on life in Ireland. Overall, only small variation can be observed between respondents in employment and respondents who are unemployed regarding attitudes towards the economic, cultural, and overall life impacts of

immigration indicating that perceptions do not vary substantially. However, across all three indicators respondents who are unemployed report less favourable attitudes with the difference between 10 (culture), 14 (economy), and 15 (place to live) percentage points in comparison to those who are in paid employment. See Question 16-17-18 (B43-44-45 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 7.3.

## 8. Religion

Figure 8.1: Population Belonging to any particular Religion: 2002-2020\*



weight: pspwght

Figure 9.1 reports the trend in Ireland in the percentage reporting that they belong to any religion. In 2023, 68% of respondents in Ireland belonged to a religion, which is slightly more than in previous years. Thus, the pattern of a steady decline that we have seen for more than a decade is reversed but not back to the highest level in 2004 (86%). Although there is variation, the majority of those indicating a religious affiliation were Roman Catholic.

See Question 19 (C11 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 8.1.

**Table 8.2:** Distribution of Belonging to any Particular Religion or Denomination by Various Characteristics

|                                    | Percentage<br>Yes | Percentage<br>No |
|------------------------------------|-------------------|------------------|
| <b>Total Population</b>            |                   |                  |
| <b>Gender</b>                      |                   |                  |
| Male                               | 64,4              | 35,6             |
| Female                             | 71,7              | 28,3             |
| <b>Age</b>                         |                   |                  |
| 25 and under                       | 55,8              | 44,2             |
| 26-35                              | 66,2              | 33,8             |
| 36-45                              | 63,4              | 36,6             |
| 46-55                              | 69,6              | 30,4             |
| 56-65                              | 71,8              | 28,2             |
| 66-75                              | 82,7              | 17,3             |
| 76 plus                            | 86,2              | 13,8             |
| <b>Highest Completed Education</b> |                   |                  |
| Less than lower secondary          | 84,6              | 15,4             |
| Lower secondary                    | 71,3              | 28,7             |
| Upper secondary                    | 66,6              | 33,4             |
| Advanced vocational                | 69,5              | 30,5             |
| Tertiary education                 | 63,3              | 36,7             |
| <b>Location</b>                    |                   |                  |
| Urban                              | 64,2              | 35,8             |
| Rural                              | 72,1              | 27,9             |

**Table 9.1** reports the percentage who do (and do not) identify with a religion/denomination in Ireland in 2023. Those who indicate an affiliation are more frequently female, older, less educated and from rural areas in Ireland. The proportion of those indicating a religion increases with age with 86% in the highest age group (76 years and older). In contrast, the youngest age group (25 years and

younger) are the least likely to identify with a religion (56%). However, this is a notable change to the previous round (49.5%). Overall, those up to the age of 55 indicate more frequently to belong to a denomination compared to the previous round. The strongest shift took place in the age group 26-35. Apart from that, nearly three out of five respondents with tertiary education belong to a religion, 85% of those with less than lower secondary school education belong to a religion. See See Question 19 (C11 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 8.2.

## 9. Climate change

Figure 9.1. Perception of Climate Change in Ireland

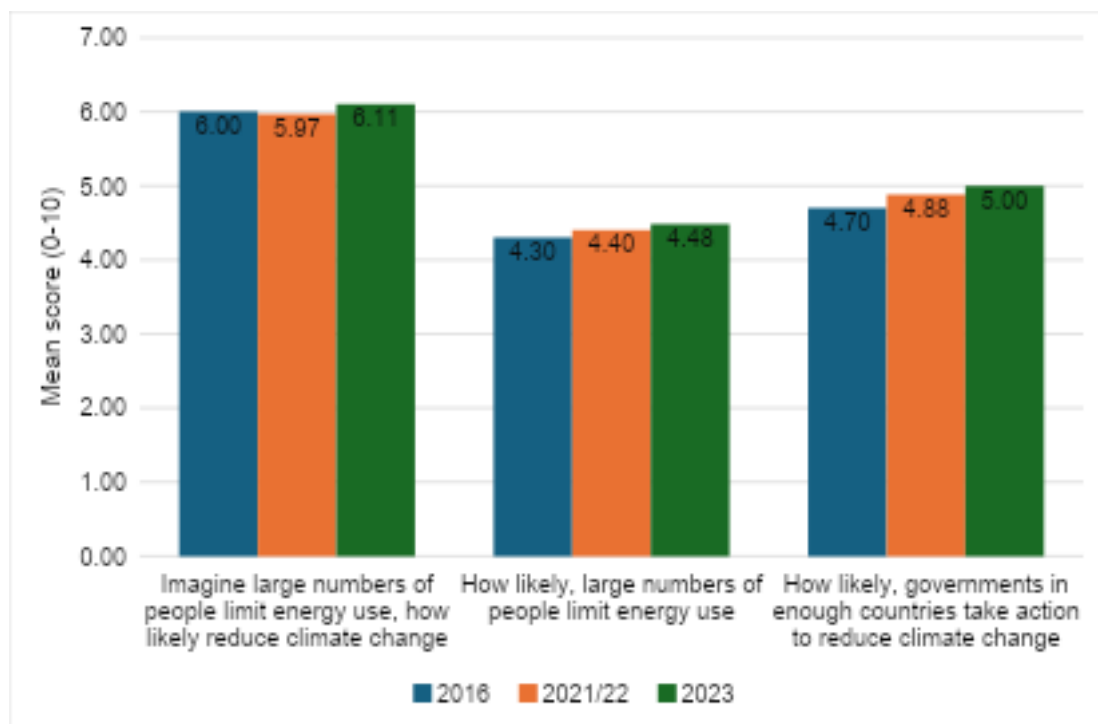


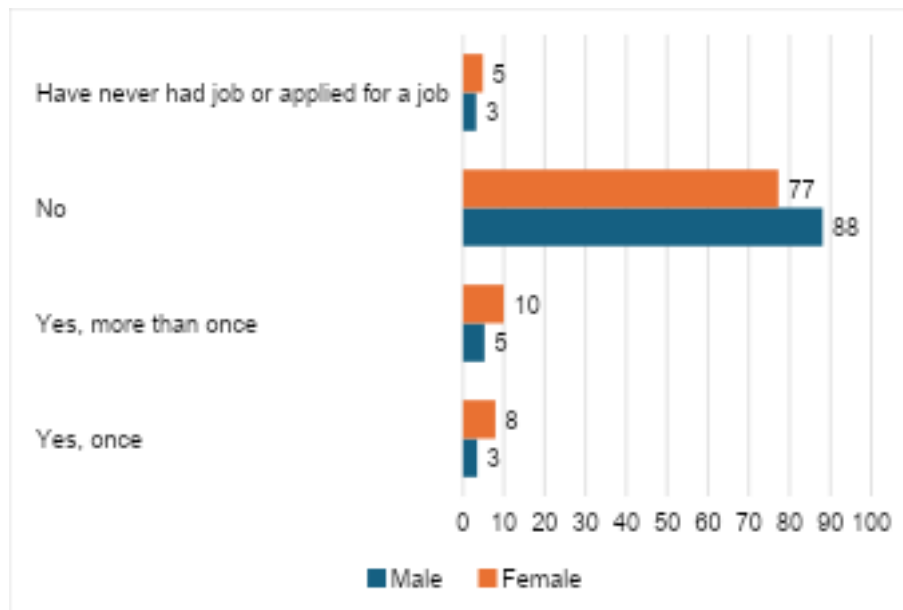
Figure 9.1 reports perceptions of climate change as the average response to three related 11-point questions. Figure 9.1 reports perceptions of climate change based on the average responses to three related 11-point scale questions. Two of these questions examine ESS respondents' attitudes regarding the likelihood of reducing climate change through limiting energy use and one focuses on whether governments in enough countries will take measures to tackle climate change.

Overall, respondents were most positive about the potential effectiveness of collective action, indicating that if large numbers of people limit their energy use, climate change could be reduced, with a mean score of 6.11 in 2023. This

represents a slight increase compared with previous survey rounds. However, respondents appear less confident that large numbers of people will actually limit their energy use, with the average score remaining below 5 in 2023, although perceptions show a modest increase from 4.3 in 2016 to 4.5 in 2023. Similarly, beliefs about whether governments in enough countries will take action to reduce climate change remain moderate but show a more positive outlook over time, increasing from 4.7 in 2016 to 5.0 in 2023. Overall, the data suggests that while people believe individual behavioural changes could help mitigate climate change, there is comparatively lower confidence that either individuals or governments will take sufficient action to achieve this. Question 20-21-22 (C34-35-36 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 9.1.

## 10. Gender

Figure 10.1: Percentage of Unfairly treated in hiring pay or promotion because being a man/woman



ESS Round 11 includes a special module titled *“Gender in Contemporary Europe: Rethinking Equality and the Backlash.”* Results from this module reveal marked gender differences in reported experiences of workplace discrimination.

Approximately 18% of women, that is, almost one in five, report having experienced unfair treatment in hiring, pay, or promotion because of their gender, either once or more than once. In contrast, the corresponding share among men is substantially lower, at around 8%, indicating a pronounced gender gap in reported gender-based discrimination in working life.

See Question 23 (E10 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 10.1.

Figure 10.2: Percentage of population unfairly treated by the police because being a man/woman

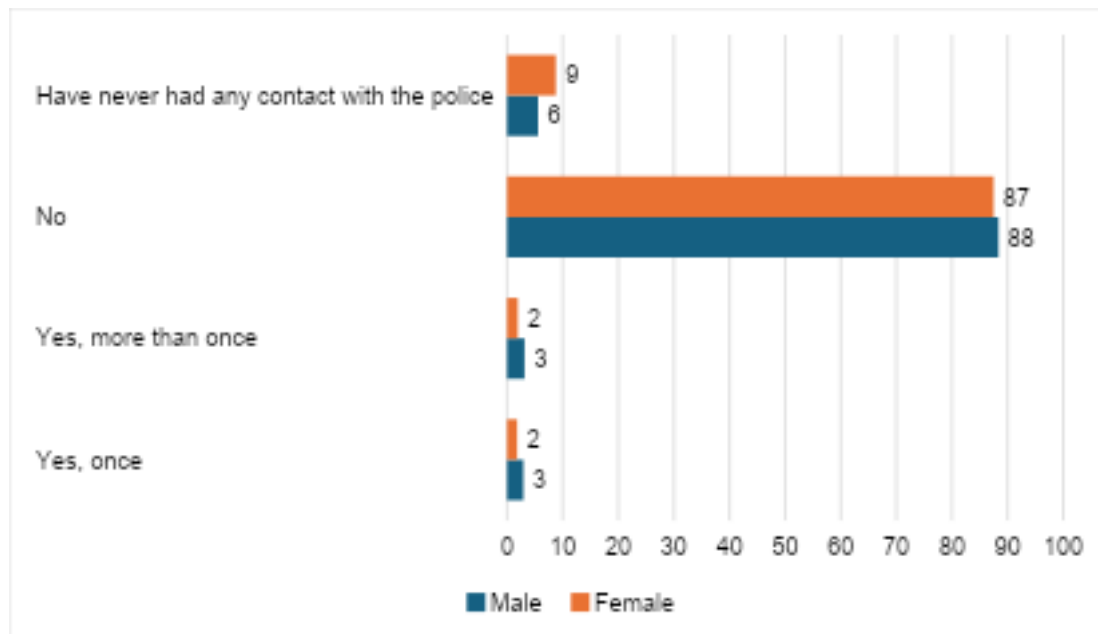


Figure 10.2 shows that reported experiences of gender-based unfair treatment by the police are rare for both women and men. The majority of respondents (approximately 87% of women and 88% of men) state that they have not been treated unfairly by the police because of their gender. 4% among women and 6% among men report such experiences either once or more than once. Overall, these findings indicate minimal gender differences and a very low prevalence of perceived gender-based discrimination in police interactions, especially when compared to the substantially higher levels observed in workplace settings.

See Question 24 (E11 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 10.2.

Figure 10.3: Percentage of population –Gender equality when seeking medical treatment

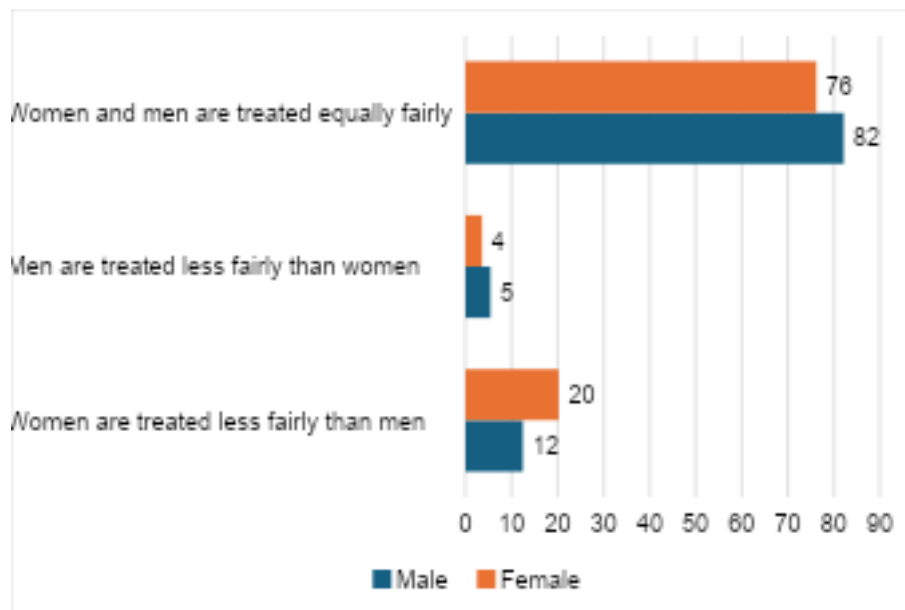


Figure 10.3 shows perceptions of gender equality in medical treatment. A clear majority of respondents believe that women and men are treated equally fairly when seeking medical care, although this view is more prevalent among men (82%) than among women (76%). At the same time, a notable gender gap emerges in perceptions of unequal treatment: 20% of women report that women are treated less fairly than men in medical settings, compared to 12% of men. Very small shares of respondents believe that men are treated less fairly than women (4% of women and 5% of men).

See Question 25 (E9 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 10.3



Figure 10.4: Percentage of the population – “If equal numbers of women and men are in paid work”

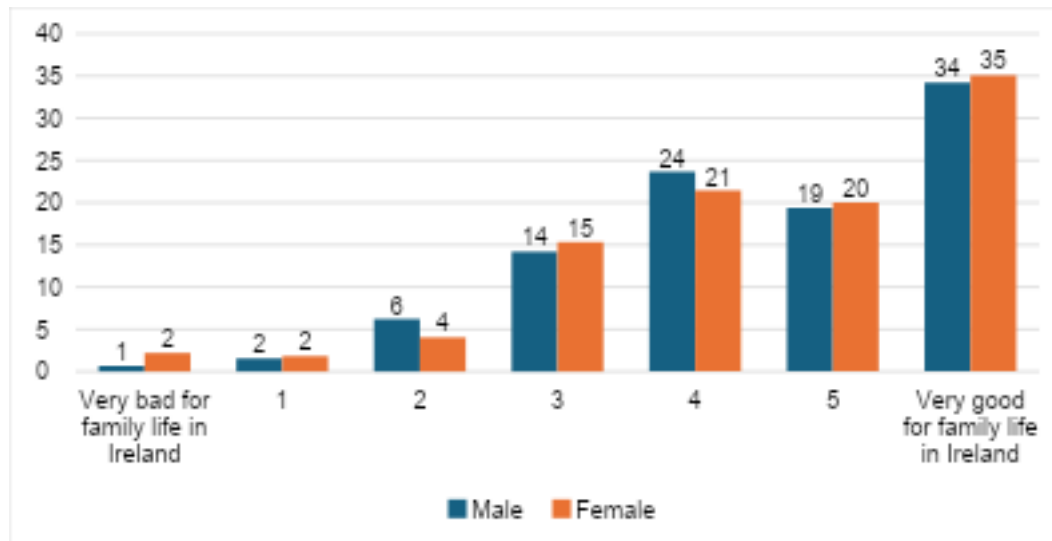


Figure 10.4 presents attitudes toward the statement that having equal numbers of women and men in paid work is good or bad for family life in Ireland, measured on a scale from 0 (very bad) to 6 (very good). Overall, responses are strongly positive. When the scale is dichotomised at the positive end (scores of 4 or higher), 77% of both women and men evaluate equal participation in paid work as good for family life, indicating a high level of consensus across genders. The single most frequent response category is “very good for family life,” selected by 35% of women and 34% of men, while negative evaluations are rare across the lower end of the scale. Overall, these results suggest widespread support for gender equality in paid work. See Question 27 (E15 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 10.4.

Figure 10.5: Percentage of the population who think that it is bad or good for politics in Ireland if equal numbers of women and men are in positions of political leadership

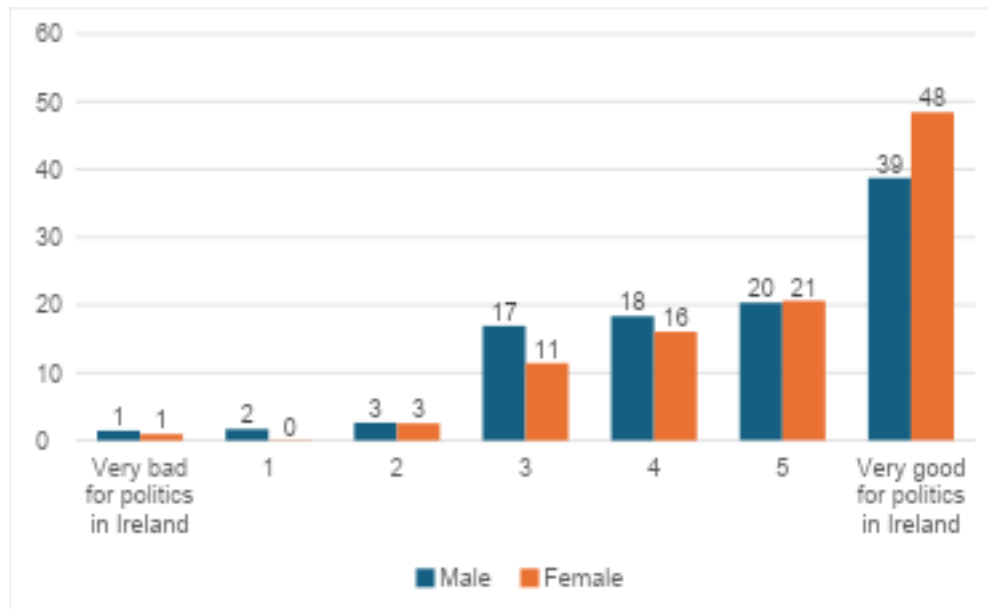


Figure 10.5 presents attitudes toward the statement that politics in Ireland is better or worse when women and men are equally represented in positions of political leadership. Overall, responses are strongly positive, particularly among women. The most common response category for both genders is the most positive option, “very good for politics in Ireland,” selected by 48% of women and 39% of men. When responses are aggregated at the positive end of the scale (scores of 4–6), a clear majority of both women and men evaluate gender-balanced political leadership as good for politics, although women express stronger support overall (Women 85%, Men 77%). Negative evaluations are very rare. Taken together, these findings suggest broad societal support for gender equality in political leadership, alongside a modest gender gap in the strength of positive attitudes. See Question 28 (E16 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 10.5.

Figure 10.6: Percentage of the population who think that it is bad or good for businesses if equal numbers of women and men are in higher management positions

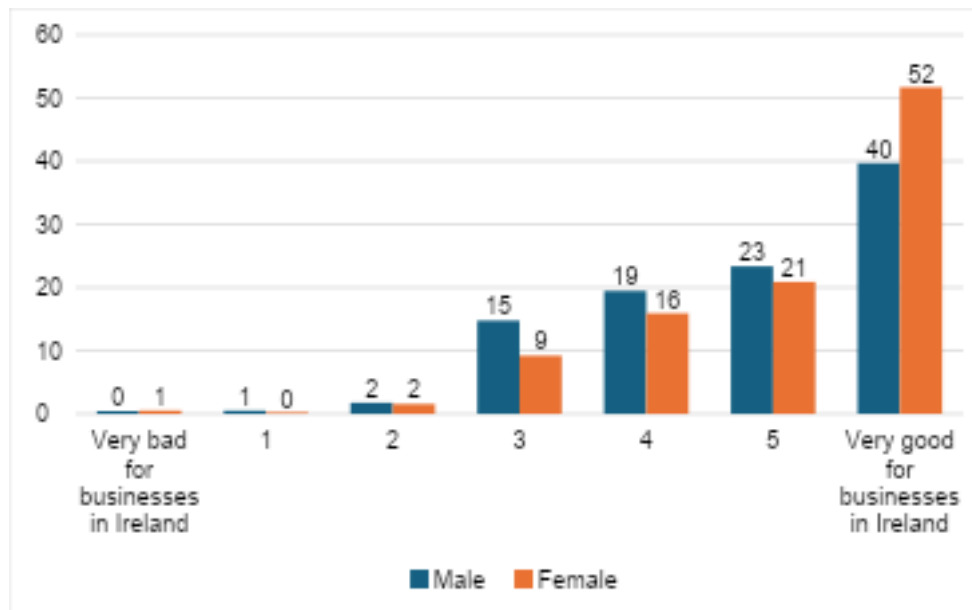


Figure 10.6 presents attitudes toward whether businesses in Ireland benefit when women and men are equally represented in higher management positions, measured on a scale from 0 (very bad) to 6 (very good). Overall, responses are strongly positive among both genders. When responses are aggregated at the positive end of the scale (scores of 4–6), 83% of men and 88% of women evaluate gender-balanced leadership as good for businesses in Ireland, indicating widespread support. The single most frequent response category is “very good for businesses in Ireland,” selected by 52% of women and 40% of men, while negative evaluations remain extremely rare across the lower end of the scale. Taken together, these findings point to broad endorsement of gender equality in business leadership, with women expressing somewhat stronger positive attitudes than men. See Question 29 (E17 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 10.6.

Figure 10.7: Percentage of the population who think that it is Bad or good for economy in Ireland if women and men receive equal pay for doing the same work

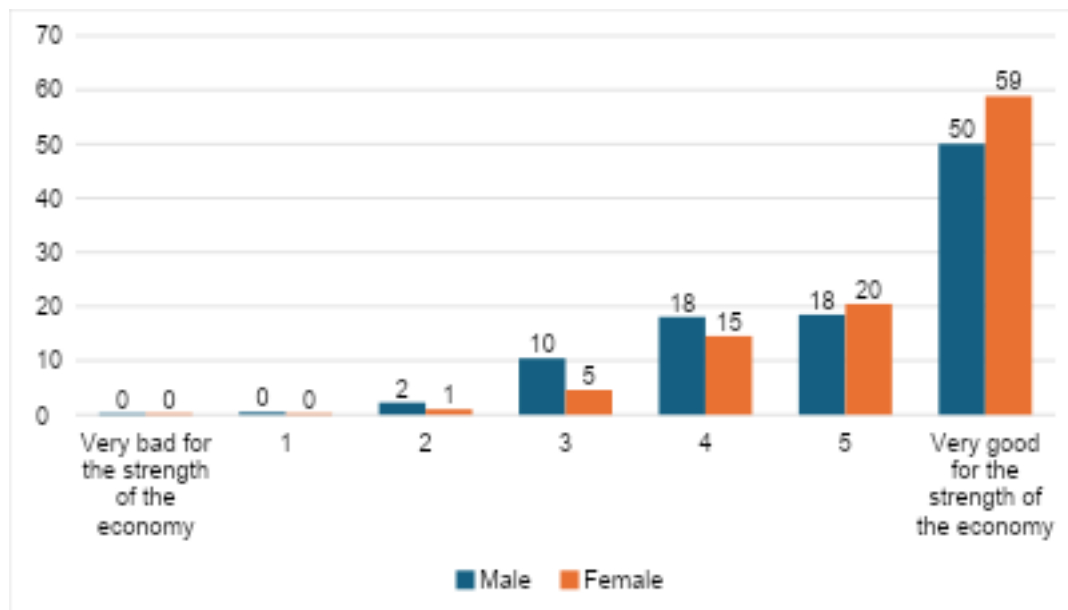


Figure 10.7 presents attitudes toward whether the Irish economy benefits when women and men receive equal pay for doing the same work, measured on a scale from 0 (very bad) to 6 (very good). When responses are aggregated at the positive end of the scale (scores of 4–6), 87% of men and 94% of women evaluate equal pay as good for the strength of the economy, indicating near-universal support. The most common response category is “very good for the strength of the economy,” selected by 59% of women and 50% of men, while negative evaluations are virtually absent across the lower end of the scale. Taken together, these findings suggest a strong societal consensus that gender pay equality is perceived as economically beneficial, with women expressing slightly stronger positive attitudes than men. See Question 30 (E18 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 10.7.

Figure 10.8: Require both parents to take equal periods of paid leave to care for their child

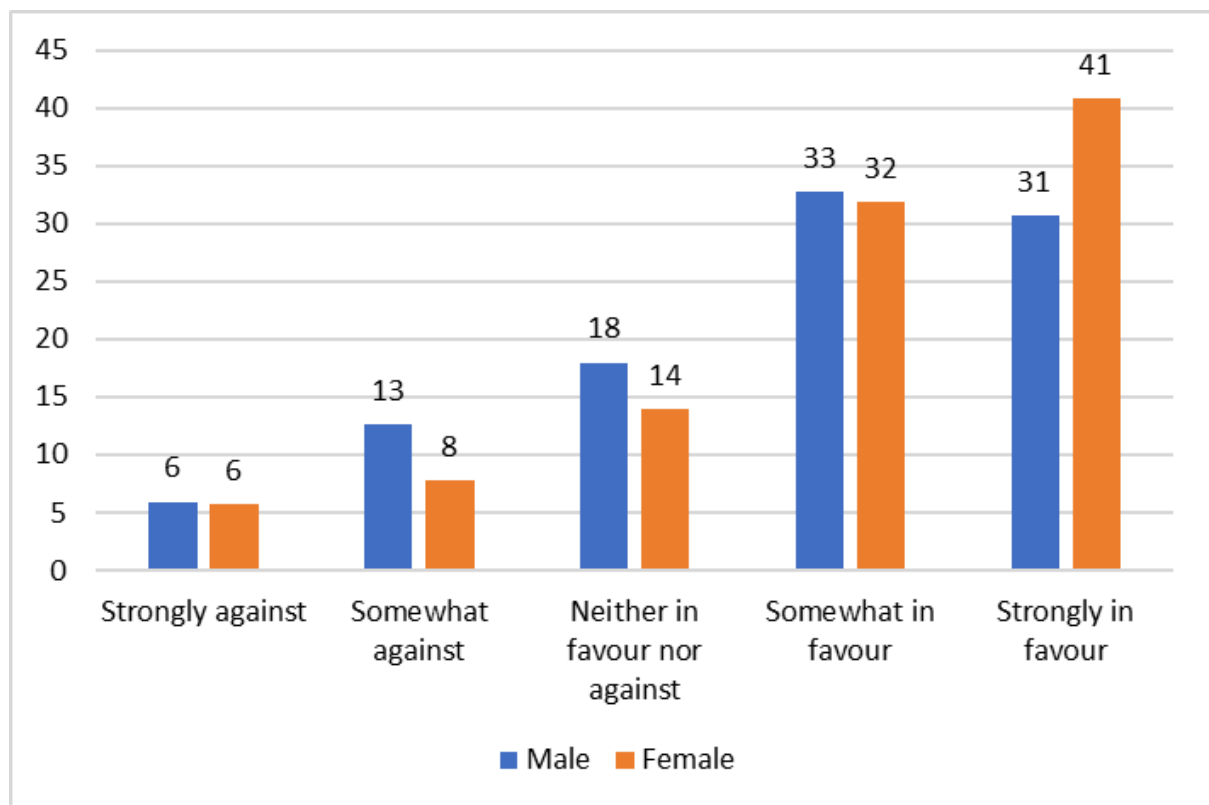


Figure 10.8 presents attitudes toward requiring both parents to take equal periods of paid leave to care for their child, measured on a scale from 1 (strongly in favour) to 5 (strongly in against). Overall, responses indicate broad support for this policy proposal, with women expressing stronger support than men. When responses are aggregated at the positive end of the scale (scores of 4–5), 63% of men and 73% of women indicate support. The most favourable response category, “strongly in favour,” is selected by 41% of women and 31% of men, while opposition remains limited across both genders. Taken together, these findings suggest substantial public backing for equal parental leave policies, alongside a clear gender gap in the strength of support, with women consistently more supportive than men. See Question 31 (E20 in ESS11) at the end of the report for the original wording and scale of the question used to generate Figure 10.8.

## Overview of the European Social Survey

### Methodology

## Sample Design and Data Collection

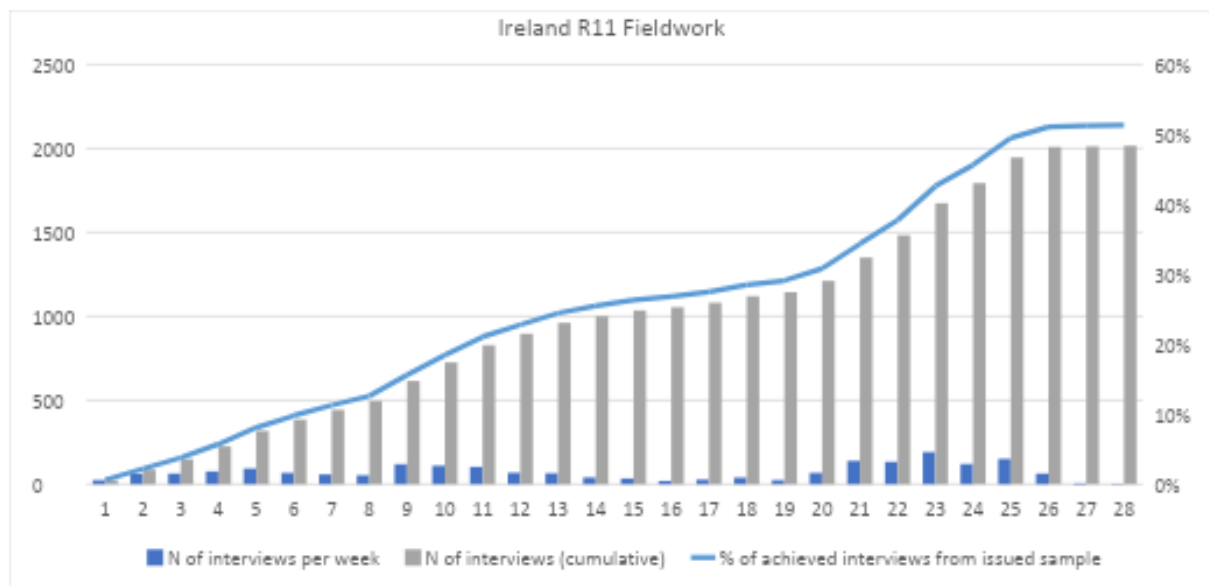
A total of 3,930 sample units were issued for data collection in Ireland. Fieldwork was conducted over a six-month period from 27 June 2023 to 3 January 2024.

## Response Rate

The survey achieved a response rate of 52.8% in Ireland, falling short of the targeted response rate of 62%. Based on the issued sample size, this response rate yielded approximately 2,075 completed interviews.

## Fieldwork Implementation

Data collection was carried out by a team of 88 trained interviewers who participated in the Irish fieldwork. This represents an average of approximately 24 completed interviews per interviewer over the fieldwork period.



## Mode

Face-to-face interview: Computer-assisted (CAPI/CAMI)

Computer-assisted personal interviewing (CAPI), or computer-assisted mobile interviewing (CAMI). Data collection method in which the interviewer reads questions to the respondents from the screen of a computer, laptop, or a mobile device like tablet or smartphone, and enters the answers in the same device. The administration of the interview is managed by a specifically designed program/application.

## Sampling procedure

Sampling Frame: Geodirectory – a national database of residential addresses

Sampling Design: A 3-stage design. First-stage units are clusters of electoral divisions (LAU2s): 655 were selected with probability proportional to number of addresses on the frame using systematic random sampling within each of 17 strata defined by a city/urban/rural classification within regions. At the second stage, 6 addresses were selected by simple random sampling within each PSU and at the third stage one individual was selected at each address using the last birthday technique.

## Type of sampling procedure

Probability: Multistage

## Key Questions and Variables Used in this Report

### **Q1.**

Generally speaking, would you say that most people can be trusted, or that you can't be too careful in dealing with people? Please tell me on a score of 0 to 10, where 0 means you can't be too careful and 10 means that most people can be trusted.



**You  
can't  
be too  
careful**

**Most  
people  
can be  
trusted** (Don't  
(Refusal) know)

00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 77 88

## Q2.

Please tell me on a score of 0-10 how much you personally trust each of the institutions I read out. 0 means you do not trust an institution at all, and 10 means you have complete trust. Firstly...

**No trust  
at all**

**Complete (Refu- (Don't  
trust sal) know)**

**B6** ... Dáil 00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 77 88  
Éireann?

**B7** ...the legal 00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 77 88  
system?

**B8** ... the 00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 77 88  
Gardaí?

**B9** ...politicians? 00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 77 88

**B10** ...political parties? 00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 77 88

**Q3.**

How is your health in general? Would you say it is.....

very good, 1

good, 2

fair, 3

bad, 4

or, very bad? 5

(Refusal) 7

(Don't know) 8

**Q4.**

Please tell me which letter describes your household's total income, after tax and compulsory deductions, from all sources? If you don't know the exact figure, please give an estimate. (The actual amounts must NOT appear on the questionnaire. Only the letters and the corresponding numeric codes.)

Approximate ANNUAL

Less than €16,500

€16,500 to under €26,000

€26,000 to under €33,000

€33,000 to under €41,500

€41,500 to under €49,000

€49,000 to under €58,500

€58,500 to under €69,500

€69,500 to under €84,000

€84,000 to under €105,500

More than €105,500

Refusal) 77

(Don't know) 88

#### Q5.

Please say what you think overall about the state of health services in Ireland nowadays?

**Extremely**

**bad**

**Extremely**

**good**

**(Refusal)**

**(Don't**

**know)**

00

01

02

03

04

05

06

07

08

09

10

77

88

#### Q6.

Taking all things together, how happy would you say you are? Please use this card.

**Extremely  
unhappy**

**Extremely  
happy**

**(Refusal)**

**(Don't  
know)**

00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 77 88

**Q7.**

In the last 12 months, were you ever unable to get a medical consultation or the treatment you needed for any of the reasons listed on this card?

Yes 1

No 2

(Refusal) 7

(Don't know) 8

**Q8.**

How much of the time during the past week did you feel this way...?

|                                                    | None<br>or<br>almost<br>none<br>of the<br>time | Some<br>of<br>the<br>time | Most<br>of<br>the<br>time | All or<br>almost<br>all of<br>the<br>time | (Refusal) | (Don't<br>know) |
|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------------|
| ...you felt depressed?                             | 1                                              | 2                         | 3                         | 4                                         | 7         | 8               |
| ...you felt that everything you did was an effort? | 1                                              | 2                         | 3                         | 4                                         | 7         | 8               |
| ...your sleep was restless?                        | 1                                              | 2                         | 3                         | 4                                         | 7         | 8               |
| ...you were happy?                                 | 1                                              | 2                         | 3                         | 4                                         | 7         | 8               |
| ...you felt lonely?                                | 1                                              | 2                         | 3                         | 4                                         | 7         | 8               |
| ...you enjoyed life?                               | 1                                              | 2                         | 3                         | 4                                         | 7         | 8               |
| ...you felt sad?                                   | 1                                              | 2                         | 3                         | 4                                         | 7         | 8               |
| ...you could not get going?                        | 1                                              | 2                         | 3                         | 4                                         | 7         | 8               |

**Q9.**

Do any of the problems listed apply to your accommodation?

|                                                    |   |
|----------------------------------------------------|---|
| Mould or rot in windows, doors or floors           | Z |
| Damp walls or leaking roof                         | F |
| Lack of indoor flushing toilet                     | T |
| Neither bath nor shower                            | K |
| Overcrowding                                       | H |
| Extremely hot or extremely cold                    | Y |
| Noise                                              | Q |
| Presence of insects or rodents (for example, mice) | E |

**Q10.**

How emotionally attached do you feel to Ireland? Please choose a number from 0 to 10, where 0 means not at all emotionally attached and 10 means very emotionally attached.

Not at  
all  
emotion  
ally  
attache  
d

Very  
emotionally  
attached

(Refusal)

(Do  
n't  
kno  
w)

00    01    0    0    0    0    0    0    08    09    10    77    88  
          2    3    4    5    6    7

Q11.

Now thinking about the European Union, some say European unification should go further. Others say it has already gone too far. Using this card, what number on the scale best describes your position?

Unification  
has  
already  
gone too  
far

Unification  
should go  
further

(Refusal)

(Don't  
know)

00    01    02    03    04    05    06    07    08    09    10    77    88

Q12.

On a score of 0-10 how much you personally trust the European Parliament?

Not at  
all  
emotion  
ally  
attache  
d

Very  
emotionally  
attached

(Do  
n't  
know)  
(Refusal)

|    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   |    |   |   |    |    |
|----|----|---|---|---|---|---|---|----|---|---|----|----|
| 00 | 01 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 08 | 0 | 1 | 77 | 88 |
|    |    | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 |    | 9 | 0 |    |    |

### Q13.

All things considered, how satisfied are you with your life as a whole nowadays?  
Please answer using this card, where 0 means extremely dissatisfied and 10 means extremely satisfied.

Extremely  
dissatisfie  
d

Extremely  
satisfied

(Don't  
know)  
(Refusal)

|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| 00 | 01 | 02 | 03 | 04 | 05 | 06 | 07 | 08 | 09 | 10 | 77 | 88 |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|

### Q14.

On the whole how satisfied are you with the present state of the economy in Ireland?  
Still use this card.

Extremely  
dissatisfied

Extremely  
satisfied

(Don't  
know)  
(Refusal)



00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 77 88

**Q15.**

Which of the descriptions on this card comes closest to how you feel about your household's income nowadays?

- |                                             |   |
|---------------------------------------------|---|
| Living comfortably on present income        | 1 |
| Coping on present income                    | 2 |
| Finding it difficult on present income      | 3 |
| Finding it very difficult on present income | 4 |
| (Refusal)                                   | 7 |
| (Don't know)                                | 8 |

**Q16.**

Would you say it is generally bad or good for Ireland's economy that people come to live here from other countries? Please use this card.

**Bad for  
the  
economy**

**Good for  
the  
economy**      **(Refusal)**      **(Don't  
know)**

00   01   02   03   04   05   06   07   08   09   10   77   88

**Q17.**

Would you say that Ireland’s cultural life is generally undermined or enriched by people coming to live here from other countries?

|                                     |                                       |                  |                         |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Cultural life<br/>undermined</b> | <b>Cultural<br/>life<br/>enriched</b> | <b>(Refusal)</b> | <b>(Don’t<br/>know)</b> |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------|

**Q18.**

00   01   02   03   04   05   06   07   08   09   10   77   88

Is Ireland made a worse or a better place to live by people coming to live here from other countries? Please use this card.

|                                    |                                     |                  |                         |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Worse<br/>place to<br/>live</b> | <b>Better<br/>place to<br/>live</b> | <b>(Refusal)</b> | <b>(Don’t<br/>know)</b> |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------|

00   01   02   03   04   05   06   07   08   09   10   77   88

**Q19.**

Do you consider yourself as belonging to any particular religion or denomination?

1 Yes

2 No

**Q20.**

Now imagine that large numbers of people limited their energy use. How likely do you think it is that this would reduce climate change?

Not at all  
likely

Extr (Refus (Don't  
eme al) know)  
ly  
likel  
y

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 77 88

**Q21.**

How likely do you think it is that large numbers of people will actually limit their energy use to try to reduce climate change?

Not at all  
likely

Extr (Refus (Don't  
eme al) know)  
ly



## Q22.

And how likely do you think it is that governments in enough countries[2] will take action that reduces climate change?



## Q23.

Have you felt you have been unfairly treated in hiring, pay or promotion at work because you are a man/woman?

Yes – once 1

|                         |   |
|-------------------------|---|
| Yes – more than<br>once | 2 |
|-------------------------|---|

|    |   |
|----|---|
| No | 3 |
|----|---|

|                                            |   |
|--------------------------------------------|---|
| Have never had job<br>or applied for a job | 4 |
|--------------------------------------------|---|

|           |   |
|-----------|---|
| (Refusal) | 7 |
|-----------|---|

|              |   |
|--------------|---|
| (Don't know) | 8 |
|--------------|---|

**Q24.**

Have you felt you have been unfairly treated by the police because you are a man/woman?

|            |   |
|------------|---|
| Yes – once | 1 |
|------------|---|

|                         |   |
|-------------------------|---|
| Yes – more than<br>once | 2 |
|-------------------------|---|

|    |   |
|----|---|
| No | 3 |
|----|---|

|                                            |   |
|--------------------------------------------|---|
| Have never had job<br>or applied for a job | 4 |
|--------------------------------------------|---|

|           |   |
|-----------|---|
| (Refusal) | 7 |
|-----------|---|

|              |   |
|--------------|---|
| (Don't know) | 8 |
|--------------|---|

**Q25.**

Have you felt you have been unfairly treated when visiting a doctor or seeking medical treatment because you are a man?

|            |   |
|------------|---|
| Yes – once | 1 |
|------------|---|

|                         |   |
|-------------------------|---|
| Yes – more than<br>once | 2 |
|-------------------------|---|

|    |   |
|----|---|
| No | 3 |
|----|---|

|                                            |   |
|--------------------------------------------|---|
| Have never had job<br>or applied for a job | 4 |
|--------------------------------------------|---|

|           |   |
|-----------|---|
| (Refusal) | 7 |
|-----------|---|

(Don't know) 8

**Q27.**

Using this card, in general, how bad or good is it for family life in Ireland if equal numbers of women and men are in paid work?

Very bad for family life in Ireland 0

1

2

3

4

5

Very good for family life in Ireland 6

(Refusal) 7

(Don't know) 8

**Q28.**

Using this card, in general, how bad or good is it for politics in Ireland if equal numbers of women and men are in positions of political leadership?

Very bad for politics in Ireland 0

1

2

3

4

5

Very good for politics in Ireland 6

(Refusal) 7

(Don't know) 8

**Q29.**

Using this card, in general, how bad or good is it for businesses in Ireland if equal numbers of women and men are in higher management positions?

Very bad for businesses in Ireland 0

1

2

3

4

5

Very good for businesses in Ireland 6



(Refusal) 7  
(Don't know) 8

**Q30.**

in general, how bad or good is it for the strength of the economy in Ireland if women and men receive equal pay for doing the same work?

Very bad for the strength of the economy in Ireland 0  
1  
2  
3  
4  
5  
Very good for the strength of the economy in Ireland 6  
(Refusal) 7  
(Don't know) 8

**Q31.**

Imagine a couple who both work full-time and earn roughly the same amount, and now have a newborn child. Both are eligible for paid leave if they stop working for some time to care for their child. Still using this card, to what extent are you in favour or against a legal measure that **requires** both parents to take **equal** periods of paid leave to care for their child?

|                               |   |
|-------------------------------|---|
| Strongly in favour            | 1 |
| Somewhat in favour            | 2 |
| Neither in favour nor against | 3 |
| Somewhat against              | 4 |
| Strongly against              | 5 |
| (Refusal)                     | 7 |
| (Don't know)                  | 8 |